The Dhāraṇī Called the Vast, Perfect, Unobstructed Mind of Great Compassion of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Who Has a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes

Toh 897 · Derge Kangyur

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The Dhāraṇī Called the Vast, Perfect, Unobstructed Mind of Great Compassion of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Who Has a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes, known in Tibetan as Phakpa Changchub Sempa Chenrezik Wangchuk Chaktong Chentong Dang Denpa, is a dhāraṇī scripture centered on the thousand-armed, thousand-eyed form of Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva who embodies the compassion of all buddhas. It opens on Mount Potala, in Avalokiteśvara's jewel-adorned celestial palace, where the Buddha Śākyamuni sits on a jeweled lion throne amid a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, including Dhāraṇīrāja, Ratnarāja, and Bhaiṣajyarāja, and prepares to teach a dhāraṇī-mantra called Total Retention. The text presents this great compassion dhāraṇī, a work closely associated with East Asian devotion to Avalokiteśvara, together with its benefits and the practices connected with it. It is Toh 897 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇīs, the class of texts devoted to sacred formulas for recitation and protection.

The Dhāraṇī Called the Vast, Perfect, Unobstructed Mind of Great Compassion of the Noble Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, Who Has a Thousand Hands and a Thousand Eyes.

The first section.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One Śākyamuni was on Mount Potala, in the maṇḍala of the jewel-adorned celestial palace of the noble Avalokiteśvara. He was seated on a jeweled lion throne beautified with many kinds of precious gems, encircled and hung with jeweled victory banners and pennants. At that time the Tathāgata, seated on that throne, wished to teach the dhāraṇī-mantra called Total Retention. He was dwelling together with countless bodhisattva great beings, namely: the bodhisattva Dhāraṇīrāja, the bodhisattva Ratnarāja, the bodhisattva Bhaiṣajyarāja, the bodhisattva

Bhaiṣajyasamudgata, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the bodhisattva Padmavyūha, the bodhisattva Mahāvyūha, the bodhisattva Ratnagarbha, the bodhisattva Śrīgarbha, the bodhisattva Vajragarbha, the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha, the bodhisattva Maitreya, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, and others. He was together with bodhisattva great beings, every one of whom had received empowerment as a great king of the Dharma.

He was also together with an immeasurable, countless great Saṅgha of śrāvakas, all of whom had practiced the ten stages of the arhat; the venerable Mahākāśyapa was foremost among them. He was also together with immeasurable gods of the Brahmā realms; the god Kṣaṇḍamara was foremost among them. He was also together with immeasurable gods and sons of gods; the god Kumbhaka was foremost among them. He was also together with immeasurable world protectors and kings of the gods of the realm of the Four Great Kings; the divine king Dhṛtarāṣṭra was foremost among them. He was also together with immeasurable gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, great mahoragas, humans, nonhumans, and others; the great nāga king Mountain Glory was foremost among them. He was also together with immeasurable goddesses of the desire realm; the goddess called Youthful Eyes was foremost among them. Moreover, immeasurable gods of the sky, of rivers and oceans, gods of springs, gods of streams, gods of medicinal herbs, gods of trees, gods of forests, gods of houses, gods of water, gods of fire, gods of wind, gods of the earth, gods of mountains, gods of celestial palaces, and others, each came from their own places and assembled there.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, within the great assembly, secretly sent forth rays of light through his miraculous power, and the world systems of the ten directions, and this great trichiliocosm as well, became golden in color. The celestial palaces of the gods, the dwellings of the nāgas, and the celestial palaces of the lords of the gods all shook violently. The rivers, the lakes, the great oceans, the encircling Cakravāla mountains, Mount Meru, the earthen mountains, and the black mountains all shook violently as well. The light of the sun, the moon, jewels, fire, the constellations, and the planets was outshone and could no longer be seen.

Then the bodhisattva Dhāraṇīrāja, seeing these wondrous and marvelous signs, was amazed, thinking, "Never before has anything like this happened." He rose from his seat, joined his palms, and said, "Blessed One, who has sent forth these signs of miraculous power?" Then he put his question in verse:

Who today has attained perfect awakening,
That such great rays of light have been sent forth,
Turning the worlds of the ten directions golden,
And likewise the great thousandfold world system?
Who today has gained mastery,
Sending forth the power of great and marvelous miracles,
So that endless buddha fields shake violently
And the palaces of gods and nāgas are unsettled?
Whose power is this? Not knowing its causes and conditions,
This great assembly is filled with doubt.
Through the Blessed One's great compassion,
Please declare the causes and conditions of this miracle.

The Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Dhāraṇīrāja: "Son of noble family, you should know this. Here today in this assembled maṇḍala of the retinue there is a bodhisattva great being called Avalokiteśvara. For immeasurable eons in the past he has been perfect in great loving-kindness and great compassion, and he has thoroughly cultivated and accomplished immeasurable gateways of dhāraṇī. Because he wishes to benefit sentient beings and bring them happiness, he has secretly displayed such great miraculous power."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara rose from his seat, arranged his robes, joined his palms toward where the Blessed One was, and said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I have a dhāraṇī-mantra called 'The Mind of Great Compassion.' I wish to explain it today for these purposes: to bring benefit and happiness to many sentient beings, to dispel all diseases, to give them long life, to make them rich and prosperous, to thoroughly purify and remove evil, non-virtuous karma and grave misdeeds, to free them from obstructing hindrances, to increase all the qualities of the white Dharma, to bring all seeds of virtue to perfection, to eliminate completely all fear and terror, and to fulfill all hopes swiftly. Blessed One, please consider this with loving-kindness and grant your permission."

The Blessed One declared: "Son of noble family, since you, out of great compassion, wish to explain the vidyā-mantra in order to benefit sentient beings and bring them happiness, the time has now come. Speak quickly! I, the Tathāgata, and the buddhas, the blessed ones, also rejoice."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara then said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I remember that in the past, as many as immeasurable hundreds of thousands of eons ago, at that time, on that occasion, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata called King of a Thousand Lights Abiding in Peace, appeared in the world. Out of love for me and for all sentient beings, that Buddha, the Blessed One, spoke this dhāraṇī called 'Unimpeded Great Compassion, Vast and Complete.' Then he stroked the crown of my head with his golden-colored hand and said, 'Son of noble family, hold this vidyā-mantra of great compassion! It will bring benefit and great happiness to all sentient beings of the evil age to come.'

"At that time I abided only on the first ground. Yet merely by hearing this vidyā-mantra once, I passed straight on to the eighth ground. At that time, on that occasion, because my mind was overjoyed and delighted, I made this aspiration: 'If in the future I am truly to be worthy of bringing benefit and happiness to all sentient beings, may a full thousand hands and a thousand eyes come forth right now from this very body of mine.' The moment I made this aspiration, a full thousand hands and a thousand eyes came forth from my body. The great earths of the ten directions shook in six ways. The buddhas of the ten directions sent forth rays of light that touched my body and illuminated the boundless world systems of the ten directions.

"From then on, in the immeasurable maṇḍalas of the assemblies of immeasurable buddhas, I heard this dhāraṇī again and again and received it directly. Moreover, by giving rise to immeasurable joy, delight, and gladness, I passed beyond the subtle saṃsāra of as many as immeasurable hundreds of thousands of eons. From then on, because I constantly recited and upheld this dhāraṇī and never let it lapse, in all my births I have always been born miraculously from a lotus in the presence of the buddhas, and I have never taken a womb-born body.

"Any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, boy, or girl who wishes to recite and uphold this should give rise to a mind of loving compassion toward sentient beings, and first of all should make this aspiration to me:

Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly realize all phenomena.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly obtain the eye of wisdom.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!

May I swiftly liberate all sentient beings.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly obtain skillful means.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly cross over in the boat of wisdom.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly pass beyond the ocean of suffering.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly gain the path that walks on moral discipline.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly climb the mountain of nirvāṇa.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly reach the home of the unconditioned.
Homage to Avalokiteśvara of great compassion!
May I swiftly become equal to the body of the nature of reality.

If I climb the mountain of swords,
may the mountain of swords crumble of itself.
If I meet the boiling waters,
may the boiling waters and burning embers subside of themselves.
If I go to the hells,
may the hells dry up of themselves.
If I go to the realm of hungry ghosts,
may their hunger and thirst be sated.
If I go to the realm of the asuras,
may their evil minds be tamed of themselves.
If I go to the realm of animals,
may they themselves gain great wisdom.

"Having made this aspiration, one should single-pointedly recite my name and recollect me. Moreover, one should recollect my teacher, the Tathāgata Amitābha. If, after that, one recites this dhāraṇī-mantra a full seven times in a single night, the grave misdeeds that would cause one to wander in saṃsāra for as many as eight hundred million eons will be completely removed and purified."

He further said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if any god or human recites and upholds these words of great compassion, at the time of death the tathāgatas of the ten directions will come there and stretch out their hands.

Thus that person will be born in whatever buddha field he wishes to be born in, just as he aspires."

He further said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if any sentient beings who recite and uphold this vidyā-mantra of great compassion should fall into the three lower realms, I will never attain full and perfect awakening.

"If those who recite and uphold the vidyā-mantra of great compassion were not to be born in the buddha fields, I would never attain complete and perfect awakening. If those who recite and uphold the vidyā-mantra of great compassion were not to obtain samādhis and eloquence beyond measure, I would never attain complete and perfect awakening. If those who recite and uphold the vidyā-mantra of great compassion were not to have all their aspirations fulfilled in this very life, just as they aspired, then it should not be called the dhāraṇī of the mind of great compassion. The only exceptions are those who are unvirtuous and those who have not made their minds one-pointed.

"Suppose a woman is utterly weary of a woman's body and wishes to obtain a man's body, and she recites and upholds these words of the dhāraṇī of the mind of great compassion. If she were not to be transformed from the state of a woman and obtain a man's body, I would never attain complete and perfect awakening. But if she gives rise to even the slightest doubt, the fruit she aspires to will certainly not come about.

"Some beings steal and squander the food and property of the Saṅgha. Even if they confessed with remorse before a thousand buddhas appearing in the world, they would not be purified and cleansed. Yet merely by reciting this vidyā-mantra of great compassion, they will be completely purified. Those who steal and squander the food of the Three Jewels and the wealth of the Three Jewels are completely purified only when they confess in the presence of the teachers of the ten directions, made manifest before them. But when this dhāraṇī of great compassion is recited, the teachers of the ten directions come to that place and preside, and so all those obscurations of misdeeds are completely purified as well.

"The ten nonvirtues, the five acts of immediate retribution, slandering persons, slandering the Dharma, breaking the poṣadha, breaking moral discipline, destroying stūpas, destroying any temple, stealing the property of the Saṅgha, defiling pure celibate conduct: all such heavy evil karma will be completely purified.

"There is one exception: doubt about this vidyā-mantra. If one has doubts, then not even the light karma of a small misdeed will be purified, so what need is there to speak of heavy misdeeds? Yet although heavy misdeeds will not be purified, it will still become a distant cause of awakening."

He also said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, gods and humans who recite and uphold this vidyā-mantra of the mind of great compassion will obtain fifteen kinds of good birth, and they will not undergo fifteen kinds of bad death.

"The bad deaths they will not die are these: that person will not die tormented by starvation; will not die by weapons, whips, or clubs; will not die at the hands of hostile enemies; will not die on the battlefield; will not die in the jaws of tigers, wolves, or savage beasts; will not die from the bite of venomous snakes, lizards, or scorpions; will not die drowning in water or burning in fire; will not die by poison; will not meet death through sorcery and curses; will not die from losing mindfulness in madness; will not die by falling from mountains, trees, cliffs, or precipices; will not die through the sorcery of malicious people; will not meet death when evil demons and malicious grahas find an opening; will not meet death with a terrible illness entangling the body; and will not meet death by harming oneself improperly. Those who recite and uphold this vidyā-mantra of great compassion will not meet death through any of these fifteen kinds of bad death.

"The fifteen kinds of good birth they will obtain are these: in all their births they will meet a virtuous king; they will always be born in a virtuous land; they will always meet with good times; they will always meet spiritual friends; their bodily faculties will always be complete; they will become accustomed to the mind of the path; they will not break the moral discipline of their vows; their retinue will be bound to them by kindness and live in harmony; the necessities of life will always be abundant and at hand; they will always be honored and served by others; their goods and possessions will not be stolen by others; the aspirations in their minds will be fulfilled just as they intend; gods and virtuous nāgas will always guard and protect them; in all their births they will see buddhas and hear the Dharma; and having heard the true Dharma, they will realize its profound meaning. Gods or humans who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī with the mind of great compassion will obtain these fifteen kinds of good birth. Therefore all gods and humans should always recite it and uphold it, and should not give way to laziness."

When the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara had said this, he joined his palms before the gathered assembly and sat upright. Generating the mind of great compassion toward beings, with a smiling radiance he spoke these magnificent words of the dhāraṇī called the Vast and Perfect Unobstructed Mind of Great Compassion:

namo ratna trayāya nama āryā palokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākaruṇikāya tadyathā oṃ sarva bandhana cchedana karāya sarva pāya samudro cchoṣaṇa karāya sarva vyādhi praśamana karāya sarva ityupadrava vināśana karāya sarva bhayeṣu tāraṇa karāya tasya nama skṛtvā idaṃ āryāvalokiteśvarāya tava nīlakaṇṭha nāma parama hṛdaya māvartayiṣyāmi sarvārtha sādhānāṃ śubha cetanāṃ sarva bhātānāṃ pāpa mārga viśodhakaṃ tadyathā āloke adhipati loka atikrānte ehyehi mahābodhisatva he bodhisatva he mahābodhisatva he priya bodhisatva he mahākāruṇika mahāsmara hṛdyan ehyehi āryāvalokiteśvarāya parama maitri citta kāraṇika kuru kuru karma sādhāya sādhaya vidyāna dehi dehi me araṃ gamaṃ gama vihaṃgama siddha yogīśvara duhu duhu vīryante mahāvīryante dhara dhara dharendeśvara cala cala vimala mūrte āryāvalokiteśvara jina kṛṣṇa jaṭā mukuṭa alaṃkṛta śarīra laṃba pralaṃba vilaṃba mahāsiddha vidyādhara bala bala mahābala mala mala mahāmala cala cala mahācala kṛṣṇa varṇa kriṣṇa vakṣa kṛṣṇa pāśa nirgātana he padma hasta cara cara niścareśvare kṛṣṇa sarva kṛta yajñopavīta ehyehi mahāvārāha mukha tripura dahaneśvara nārāyaṇa bala rūpa veṣa dhara he nīlakaṇṭha ehyehi mahāhala hala viṣa nirjjata lokasya rāga viṣa vināśanaṃ dveṣa viṣa vināśanaṃ moha giṣa vināśanaṃ nirmokṣaṇa hulu hulu muñca muñca muhu muhu rāhula rāhula hala halā hāre mahāpadmanābhi sara sara siri siri suru suru buddhya buddhya bodhaya bodhaya bodhayāmi tava nīlakaṇṭha ehyehi nīlakaṇṭha ehyehi vāma sthita mahāsiṃha mukha hasa hasa muñca muñca mahāṭṭāṭṭa hāsya ehyehi bho bho mahāsiddha yogīśvara bhaṇa bhaṇa vāca sādhaya sādhaya vidyāṃ smara smara tvaṃ he bhagavantā loka viloka tvaṃ tathāgatānāṃ dadāhi me darśana kāmasya darśanāṃ prasādhaya me svāhā siddhāya svāhā mahāsiddhāya svāhā siddha yogīśvarāya svāhā nīlakaṇṣāya svāhā vārāha mukhāya svāhā mahāvārāha mukhāya svāhā narasiṃha mukhāya svāhā mahānarasiṃha mukhāya svāhā vajra hastāya svāhā mahāvajra hastāya svāhā siddha vidyādharāya svāhā mahāsiddha vidyādharāya svāhā padma hastāya svāhā mahāpadma hastāya svāhā kṛṣṇa sarva kṛta yajñopavītāya svāhā mahāmāla mukuṭa dharāya svāhā cakrāyudha dharāya svāhā śaṃkha śabda nibodhanāya svāhā vāma skandha deśa sthi kṛṣṇājināya svāhā vāma

hasta vyāghra carma nivāsanāya svāhā lokeśvarāya svāhā mahālokeśvarāya svāhā sarva siddhiśvarāya svāhā rakṣa rakṣa māṃ svāhā kuru rakṣa mudrāṇāṃ svāhā namo bhagavate āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya siddhyantu me mantra pādāni svāhā

As soon as the bodhisattva, the great being, noble Avalokiteśvara had spoken this vidyā-mantra, the great earth shook in six ways. The gods rained down a shower of jewel flowers. The buddhas of the ten directions rejoiced. The māras among the sons of the gods and the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) were terrified and frightened, and their hair stood on end. Of all the many who had gathered in the assembly, some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some attained the fruit of once-returning, some attained the fruit of non-returning, and some attained the fruit of arhatship. Some attained the first ground, the second ground, the third ground, the fourth ground and the fifth ground, and so on up to the tenth ground. Countless sentient beings gave rise to the mind set on awakening.

Then Great Brahmā rose from his seat, arranged his robes, respectfully joined his palms, and spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara: "O great being, excellent! In times past, in countless assemblies of tathāgatas, I have heard many kinds of Dharma teachings and many kinds of dhāraṇīs, yet never before have I heard such excellent words of the vidyā-mantra of the great dhāraṇī of the mind of unimpeded great compassion. Great being, please explain to me in detail the defining characteristics of the nature of this dhāraṇī. All of us in this great assembly long to hear it."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara said to Great Brahmā, "King of the gods, you have asked this with skillful means, in order to benefit all sentient beings. So listen well now, and I shall explain it to you briefly."

The bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara said, "It is the mind of great compassion. It is the mind of equality. It is the unconditioned mind. It is the mind free of clinging. It is the mind that views emptiness. It is the mind of reverence. It is the sublime mind. It is the unmixed mind. It is the mind of unsurpassed awakening. Know that whatever minds are of this kind, they are the characteristics of the dhāraṇī. You should accomplish it in just this way."

Brahmā, the great king, said, "Now at last all of us in this great assembly have understood what the characteristics of this dhāraṇī are, and from this day on, having taken it to heart, we could never bring ourselves to forget it."

Noble Avalokiteśvara said, "Whatever son of good family or daughter of good family recites and upholds this vidyā-mantra should give rise to the vast awakening mind and should truly take the vow to bring all sentient beings to complete nirvāṇa.

Abiding oneself in the restoration ceremony (poṣadha) and in moral discipline, and giving rise to an impartial mind toward all sentient beings, one should recite this vidyā-mantra constantly and without interruption. One should stay in a clean dwelling, bathe until thoroughly pure, and put on clean clothes. One should hang banners, light lamps, and make offerings of incense, flowers and food. Then, with the mind fixed one-pointedly and not resting on any other object, one should recite it and keep it in accordance with the Dharma. When one does so, the bodhisattva Sūryaprabha, the bodhisattva Candraprabha, the gods, and countless sages will come there, lend their power, and also show signs. At that time I too will look upon that person with a thousand eyes, and with a thousand hands I will protect and bless him. Because of this he will master all the treatises of the world, whatever they may be. He will also understand and comprehend all the rites of the Dharma of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and all of their teachings, whatever they may be.

Whoever recites and keeps this vidyā-mantra will heal and keep alive those afflicted by the eighty-four thousand kinds of grahas and diseases in the world. He will gain power over all ghosts and demons, subdue the māras who are sons of the gods, and also defeat the non-Buddhists. If, while one dwells on a mountain or in a hermitage, reciting the sūtras and meditating in concentration, the mountain gods and harmful ghosts and demons harass one forcefully, so that the mind cannot settle in meditative equipoise, then if one recites this vidyā-mantra once, all those ghosts and demons will die.

If someone recites it in accordance with the Dharma and gives rise to a loving mind toward sentient beings, then at that time I shall command the virtuous gods, all the nāga kings, and the Guhyaka Vajrapāṇis: "Always follow him and protect him! Stay near him and guard him as you would the apple of your eye! Shield him as you would your own life force!"

To show whom he commands, he spoke in verse:

I send Vajradhara, Lord of Secrets,
Amṛtakuṇḍalin, Ucchuṣma, and the Hook-Bearer,
Mighty Śaṅkara, and the eight classes,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.

I send Maheśvara and the Mighty One,
Kubera, and the Lord of Kapila,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send the Treasure Guardian, Varuṇa,
Pūrṇabhadra, and Paricitra,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send Sasarca and Mahāra,
Kulantanta and Pāñcika,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send the king Pipakala,
The glorious Pyita, and Svārhārā,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send Brahmā and Sambara,
The five classes of the Pure Abodes, and Yama,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send Śakra (Indra) and the gods of the Thirty-Three,
Great Eloquence, the Glorious One, and Satana,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send King Dhṛtarāṣṭra
And the mighty retinue of mātṛkā goddesses and the rest,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send King Virūḍhaka,
And Virūpākṣa and Vaiśravaṇa as well,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send the golden Peacock King,
The twenty-eight commanders, and the retinue of sages,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send Maṇibhadra,
The great general Earth-Holder, and Phulapa,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send Nanda and Upananda,
The nāga kings Sāgara and Elāpattra,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send the asuras and gandharvas,
The garuḍas, kinnaras and mahoragas,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.
I send the gods of water, fire and lightning,

The lord of the kumbhāṇḍas, and the piśācas,
Ever to protect the holder of the dhāraṇī.

Those virtuous gods, the nāga kings, the mātṛkās and the rest, each with a retinue of five hundred, and the yakṣas of great might as well, always guard and shield the one who recites and keeps the vidyā-mantra of great compassion. Therefore, even if that person sleeps alone on a mountain or in a hermitage, those virtuous gods take turns guarding him through the night and clear away all obstructors and hindrances. If, while staying in mountain gorges, one loses the way and recites this vidyā-mantra, then by its power the virtuous gods and the nāga kings will emanate in the form of good people and show the true path. If, while staying in mountains, forests and hermitages, one is in want of water and fire, the nāga kings, in order to protect him, will conjure up water and fire.

Further, for the sake of those who recite and keep this dhāraṇī, and in order to clear away harms and obstructors, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke these most cooling verses:

Whoever goes into the mountains and the wilderness,
though meeting tigers, wolves and savage beasts of prey,
lions, snakes, ghosts and rākṣasas,
if they hear this dhāraṇī recited, they will be powerless to harm.
Whoever enters rivers or the ocean,
venomous nāgas and fierce sea monsters (makaras),
yakṣas, rākṣasas, fish and turtles,
on hearing this dhāraṇī, will scatter each its own way.
Whoever in battle is surrounded by foes,
or when savage bandits and thieves are robbing his wealth,
if he single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
they will give rise to kindly thoughts and turn back.
Whoever is caught up in a lawsuit before the king,
when bound in iron chains and cast into prison,
if he single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
the king, with kindly thoughts, will set him free.
Whoever enters a house of sorcery and poisoned darts,
when he is to be killed with poisoned food and drink,
if he single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
the poison itself will turn into sweet nectar food and drink.

When a pregnant woman is giving birth to her child,
when māras create obstacles and the suffering is unbearable,
if she single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
the ghosts and grahas will scatter, and she will give birth with ease.
When a fierce nāga graha breathes out its venomous breath,
and one, stricken by fever, is close to death,
if one single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
the epidemic will be dispelled and one's life will be long.
When tormented by roaming nāga grahas and swollen,
with terrible ulcers oozing pus and blood,
if one single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
by smearing on spittle three times, the swelling subsides.
When beings, through their thoughts, give rise to nonvirtue,
and one is tormented by sorcery, mantras and enemies,
if one single-pointedly recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
all that sorcerous harm will gather upon the one who sent it.
When, in degenerate times of increasing evil, the true Dharma perishes,
and through the great fire of desire minds are deluded and perverse,
husbands and wives each lusting after others,
day and night the stream of wrong thoughts unbroken,
whoever recites the dhāraṇī of Great Compassion,
the fire of desire will be quenched and the perverse mind removed.
Were I to proclaim in full the might and power of this dhāraṇī,
even speaking for an eon, I would never come to the end.

Having recited this vidyā-mantra five times, one should tie twenty-four knots in a thread of five colors and fasten it at the neck.

This dhāraṇī has been spoken by past tathāgatas as numerous as the sands of ninety-nine koṭis of Ganges rivers. Those tathāgatas spoke it in order to bring to completion those yogis who have not completed the accomplishment of the six perfections; in order that those who have not generated the mind of awakening may quickly generate the mind of awakening; in order that those śrāvaka individuals who have not actualized the fruit may quickly actualize it; in order that those sages in the great trichiliocosm who have not generated the mind toward unsurpassed awakening may quickly generate that mind; and in order that those beings who have not obtained the faculty of faith in this Great Vehicle may, through the power of the blessing of this dhāraṇī, have the

seeds of the Great Vehicle and the sprouts of the Dharma increase. Therefore, by the power of skillful means, loving-kindness and compassion, I bring about the fulfillment of all that each of them desires.

Moreover, if all the beings of the three lower realms dwelling in places of gloom and darkness in the great trichiliocosm hear this vidyā-mantra of mine, all of them will be freed from suffering. Those bodhisattvas who have not attained the first ground will quickly attain it, and they will attain what they have not attained, all the way up to the tenth ground. Moreover, because it brings them all the way to the ground of buddhahood, they will spontaneously obtain the thirty-two major marks and the eighty minor marks as well.

If śrāvaka individuals hear this dhāraṇī with their ears even once, or practice this dhāraṇī and write it down, or abide in accordance with the Dharma with an upright mind, they will spontaneously obtain the four fruits of the ascetic without seeking them.

It is able to make all the mountains, rivers and cliffs in the great trichiliocosm, and all the waters of the four great oceans, shake and boil. It is able to make everything from Mount Meru to the Cakravāla mountains shake and crumble into atoms. It is able to cause all the beings dwelling there to generate the mind toward unsurpassed awakening.

If beings wish their aspirations to be accomplished in this very life, and for twenty-one days they keep the poṣadha and moral discipline and recite this dhāraṇī, without doubt their aspirations will be accomplished. And all their evil karma, from the beginning of saṃsāra to the very end of saṃsāra, will be purified without exception. All the buddhas and bodhisattvas residing within and beyond this great trichiliocosm, and Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), the Four Great Kings, the gods, the sages, and all the nāga kings dwelling there, will know and be aware of it.

Whether they are gods or humans, when those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī enter a river or the ocean and bathe there, if the water that has washed their bodies touches the bodies of the beings who live there, those beings will be wholly purified of all their evil deeds and grave misdeeds, and will be born miraculously from lotuses in completely pure fields. They will no longer take a body born from a womb, from warmth and moisture, or from an egg. If that is so, what need is there to speak of those who take it up, hold it, read it, and recite it?

When those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī are walking along a road and a great wind arises, whatever wind blows on that person's body, body hair, head hair, and clothes goes downwind, and if it touches the bodies of other beings, all their obscurations and grave evil deeds will be purified without remainder. They will no longer experience the ripening of the three lower realms, and they will always be born in the presence of a buddha. Therefore it should be understood that the merit and the ripened fruit of those who uphold it are inconceivable.

Whatever words come out of the mouth of one who recites this dhāraṇī, whether wholesome or unwholesome, if they are heard by the māras who are sons of the gods, by non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), and by all the gods, nāgas, ghosts, and demons, all of them become the utterly pure realm of phenomena itself. So they will arouse a respectful mind toward that person, just as toward a buddha, and will honor and serve him.

Those who recite and uphold this dhāraṇī should be understood to be a treasury of the very body of the Buddha, because buddhas as numerous as the sands of ninety-nine koṭis of Ganges rivers hold them dear and cherish them.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of a luminous body, because the light rays of all the tathāgatas illuminate him.

That person should also be understood to be a treasury of loving-kindness and compassion, because through the dhāraṇī he protects sentient beings.

That person should be understood to be a basket of the sublime Dharma, because he gathers all the gateways of dhāraṇī.

That person should be understood to be a basket of meditative concentration and samādhi, because hundreds of thousands of samādhis are always directly present to him.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of space, because he always looks upon sentient beings with the wisdom of emptiness.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of fearlessness, because gods, nāgas, and benevolent deities always protect him.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of sublime speech, because the sound of the dhāraṇī issues from his mouth without interruption.

That person should be understood to be a treasure of permanence, because the eons of the three destructions cannot destroy him.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of liberation, because the māras who are sons of the gods and the non-Buddhists cannot hinder him.

That person should be understood to be a treasury of Bhaiṣajyarāja, the Medicine King, because through the dhāraṇī he always heals the illnesses of sick beings.

That person should be understood to be a treasure of miraculous power, because he has gained mastery in traveling to the buddha fields.

Therefore, if one were to proclaim the praise of that person's qualities, it would never come to an end.

If any son of good family, thoroughly weary of the sufferings of the world, wishes to seek the medicine of long life, he should stay in a secluded place, set up a boundary in a completely pure way, consecrate his clothes with the mantra, and then put them on. If he consecrates water, food, incense, and medicines with the mantra one hundred and eight times and then uses them, he will without doubt have a long life.

If one sets up the boundary in accordance with the Dharma and upholds this in accordance with the Dharma, everything will be accomplished. The rite for setting up the boundary is this: consecrate a sword with the mantra twenty-one times, draw lines on the ground, and so set up the boundary. Or else consecrate clean water with the mantra twenty-one times, scatter it in the four directions, and so set up the boundary. Or else consecrate white mustard seeds with the mantra twenty-one times, scatter them in the four directions, and so set up the boundary. Or else, however far one's thought reaches, that becomes the boundary. Or else consecrate clean ash with the mantra twenty-one times and so set up the boundary. Or else consecrate a thread of five colors with the mantra twenty-one times, encircle the four directions with it, and so set up the boundary. If one upholds this in accordance with the Dharma in this way, the fruit will be attained of itself.

If merely hearing the name of this dhāraṇī purifies the grave misdeeds of saṃsāra accumulated over immeasurable eons, what need is there to speak of reciting and upholding it? Whoever recites this vidyā-mantra should be understood to have made offerings to and served immeasurable buddhas, and so to have generated vast roots of virtue.

Those who recite it in accordance with the Dharma in order to lead sentient beings out of the obstructions of suffering should be understood to possess

great compassion, and so before long they will become fully and perfectly awakened.

If one recites it for the sake of all the beings one sees, making it resound in their ears so that it becomes a cause of awakening for them, those persons will attain immeasurable, incalculable qualities, more than words can tell.

If anyone, with a one-pointed mind, keeps mind and body in the poṣadha observance and in moral discipline, confesses the misdeeds of the past karma of all sentient beings, and openly confesses the many kinds of evil deeds he himself has done for immeasurable eons, and then swiftly recites this dhāraṇī aloud without letting the sound break off, he will attain the four fruits of the renunciant in this very life.

If one has sharp faculties, is endowed with wisdom, and is skilled in the methods of meditation, then even the fruit of the ten grounds is attained without difficulty. What need, then, to mention the mere accomplishment of the minor ripenings of worldly merit that one may seek? This is because the power of the bodhisattva's great compassion and aspiration is extremely profound, and because the blessing of this dhāraṇī is extremely vast.

The Blessed One (the Buddha) said to Ānanda: "If calamities arise in any country, the king of that country should govern it by the true Dharma, set his people at ease, deal with no being unjustly, and spare those who have committed offenses. If he then generates diligence of body and mind for seven days and nights and recites this dhāraṇī-mantra of the mind of great compassion, all the calamities and obstructors of that country will be dispelled. The crops will be good, and the many people will be happy.

"Furthermore, enemies from other lands may come again and again to harass it, so that many subjects are unhappy; or a great minister may plot in secret and rebel; or an epidemic may break out; or a great drought may occur; or the sun and moon may stray from their courses. When such calamities as these arise, one should make an image of the thousand-eyed one endowed with great compassion, set it facing in that direction, and with one-pointed mind make offerings to it of incense, flowers, victory banners, pennants, jeweled canopies of many kinds, and food and drink of a hundred flavors. Further, if that king generates diligence of body and mind for seven days and nights and recites these sublime words of the dhāraṇī, the enemies from other lands will be tamed of their own accord and turn back. Each will govern his own land properly, the lands will live side by side, and they will regard one another with

minds of loving-kindness. The princes and ministers will serve the government and act with uprightness. The queens and sons will serve and honor the king. The gods, nāgas, spirits and rākṣasas will guard and protect that country. Rain will fall in its season, the crops will be good, and so the many people will rejoice greatly.

"Furthermore, a household may meet with a terrible and grave illness; or various ill omens may appear; or spirits, rākṣasas and perverse māras may throw the household into turmoil; or evil people may slander it, plot in secret and do it harm; or the members of the household, old and young, within and without, may fall into discord. Then, before an image of the thousand-eyed one endowed with great compassion, one should make a maṇḍala, bring the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara to mind with one-pointed attention, and recite this dhāraṇī-mantra a full thousand times. All the evil things mentioned above will then be completely cleared away."

The venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this vidyā-mantra? How should it be upheld?"

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, this vidyā-mantra has many different names. It is called Vast and Perfectly Complete. It is also called Unobstructed Great Compassion. It is also called the Dhāraṇī That Rescues from Sufferings. It is also called the Dhāraṇī That Lengthens Life. It is also called the Dhāraṇī That Purifies the Lower Realms. It is also called the Dhāraṇī That Destroys Karmic Obscurations. It is also called the Dhāraṇī That Fulfills Wishes. It is also called the Dhāraṇī of Mastery in Accord with the Mind. It is also called the Dhāraṇī of Swiftly Passing On to the Higher Grounds. Thus should it be upheld."

The venerable Ānanda said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this bodhisattva-mahāsattva, who is so skilled in teaching such a dhāraṇī as this?"

The Blessed One said: "The name of this bodhisattva is Avalokiteśvara. He is also called Amoghapāśa. He is also called the One with Eyes of a Thousand Lights. Son of noble family, the name, splendor and might of this bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara are inconceivable. Immeasurable eons ago in the past he attained full awakening and bore the name Tathāgata Light of the True Dharma. Yet through the power of his great compassion and aspiration, in order to bring happiness to sentient beings, he manifests in the body of a bodhisattva. Therefore you, the great assembly of bodhisattva-mahāsattvas, together with Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), the gods and the nāgas, should

reverently honor him and never disparage him. If all gods and humans constantly make offerings to him and recite his name with one-pointed mind, they will obtain immeasurable merit, be cleansed of immeasurable misdeeds, and after death will be born in the buddhafield of the Tathāgata Amitābha."

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, if one wishes to be rich and abundantly endowed with all kinds of jewels, one should make offerings to the hand holding the wish-fulfilling jewel.
If one is tormented by various kinds of distress, make offerings to the hand holding the lasso.
If one has internal diseases, make offerings to the hand holding the jeweled alms bowl.
If one wishes to subdue all spirits and grahas, make offerings to the hand holding the jeweled sword.
If one wishes to tame all the devaputra māras, make offerings to the hand holding the vajra.
If one wishes to vanquish hostile enemies, make offerings to the hand holding the vajra hammer.
If one wishes to be freed from all fearful and anxious situations, make offerings to the hand bestowing fearlessness.
If one's eyes are dim and lack light, make offerings to the hand holding the sun-crystal jewel.
If one is stricken by a burning fever and wishes to be cooled, make offerings to the hand holding the water-crystal jewel.
If one wishes for high official rank, make offerings to the hand holding the jeweled bow.
If one wishes to meet friends and companions quickly, make offerings to the hand holding the jeweled arrow.
If one's body is afflicted by various diseases, make offerings to the hand holding the willow branch.

If one wishes to dispel malevolent obstructors of the body, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the white yak-tail whisk. If one wishes everyone to become a harmonious retinue, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the vase. If one wishes to avoid tigers, wolves, bears, and all fierce beasts of prey, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the shield. If one wishes to be freed from obstructions caused by kings in every place and at every time, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the battle-axe. For the sake of sons, daughters, and servants, one makes offerings to the hand that

holds the crystal ring. For the sake of qualities of every kind, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the white lotus. If one wishes to be born in the pure realms of the ten directions, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the blue lotus. If one wishes to possess great wisdom, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel mirror. If one wishes to see the tathāgatas of the ten directions directly, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the red lotus. If one wishes to bring forth treasures from the earth, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel casket. If one wishes to accomplish the path of the sages, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the five-colored cloud. If one wishes to be born as Brahmā, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the water flask. If one wishes to be born in a celestial palace of the gods, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the purple lotus. If one wishes to repel hostile enemies from other regions, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the sword and spear. If one wishes to summon all virtuous gods and spirits, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel conch. If one wishes to bring all gods and spirits into service, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the skull staff. If one wishes the buddhas of the ten directions to come swiftly and touch one with their hands, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the rosary. If one wishes to accomplish fully the supreme and sublime voice of Brahmā, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel bell. If one wishes to possess excellent eloquence of speech, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel seal. If one wishes the virtuous gods and nāgas always to come and guard and fully protect one, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the iron hook. If one wishes to protect all sentient beings fully with loving-kindness and compassion, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the ringing staff. If one wishes all sentient beings always to honor one another with respect and think of one another with affection, one makes offerings to the hands joined with palms together. If one wishes never to be separated from the tathāgatas in any birthplace in which one is born, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the emanated buddha. If one wishes always to dwell in the palace of the Tathāgata in all one's lifetimes and not to be born within a womb, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the emanated celestial palace. If one wishes to possess the vast knowledge of great learning, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the jewel volume of the sūtras. If one wishes never to turn back from the awakening mind, from this present body until reaching the body of a buddha, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the golden wheel of non-return. If one wishes the tathāgatas of the ten directions to come swiftly,

touch one's crown with their hands, and give prophecy, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the emanated buddha upon the crown. If one wishes fruits and grains to flourish, one makes offerings to the hand that holds the grapes.

Although there are a thousand such rites of accomplishment, I have now condensed them and taught only a brief outline.

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, with a mind of utmost faith you should uphold this dhāraṇī, spread it far and wide throughout Jambudvīpa, and keep it from ever being interrupted. Because this dhāraṇī greatly benefits all the sentient beings of the three realms who are afflicted by illness, there is none who would not recover if healed by this dhāraṇī. If even a dry tree on which this great vidyā-mantra is cast will sprout branches, leaves, flowers, and fruit, what need is there to speak of sentient beings endowed with consciousness? When sentient beings stricken by illness are healed by it, there is certainly no case in which they will not recover.

"Son of noble family, even if one were to praise the inconceivable blessing and power of this dhāraṇī, one would never reach the end. Unless one has generated vast roots of virtue over long ages in the past, one will not hear even so much as its name, so what need is there to speak of seeing it directly? All of you in this great assembly of gods, humans, nāgas, and others, having heard me praise this dhāraṇī, should all rejoice in it.

"Whoever disparages this vidyā-mantra will be disparaging as many buddhas as there are grains of sand in ninety-nine koṭis of Ganges rivers. If doubt and disbelief toward this dhāraṇī should arise, that person will be separated forever from its great benefits, and so will wander in the lower realms for hundreds of thousands of eons with no time of escape. Know that such a person will never see the Buddha, never hear the Dharma, and never see the Saṅgha."

Then the great bodhisattvas gathered in that assembly, the Lord of Secrets Vajrapāṇi, Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), the Four Great Kings, and all the gods, nāgas, spirits, and demons, having heard the Blessed One praise this dhāraṇī, were all overjoyed and delighted. They accepted his command and put it into practice.

Then the bodhisattva Sūryaprabha spoke this great vidyā-mantra in order to protect fully those who uphold the dhāraṇī of great compassion:

namo buddha gurabe namo dharma mahate namaḥ saṃgha ṭayāṇi tripubisātataṃ namaḥ

When this vidyā-mantra is recited, all misdeeds are purified, māras are cast out, and obstructors are dispelled. Therefore, after each recitation one should prostrate once to the Buddha. Likewise, if one recites the vidyā-mantra three times each day and prostrates to the Buddha, then in all one's future births one will obtain, as karmic ripening, each of the delightful and exceedingly beautiful major marks.

The bodhisattva Candraprabha also spoke this dhāraṇī in order to protect yogins fully:

sintitedu soṣṭa ajñāmite otuṣṭa sinikhi tapali tiṣṭa yamijñāta odhuṣṭa kulati maṣṭa khiṣṭa svāhā

One should recite this vidyā-mantra five times, tie mantra knots in a thread of five colors, and fasten it wherever there is pain. "This vidyā-mantra was spoken by past buddhas as many as the grains of sand in forty Ganges rivers. Therefore I too now teach it, in order to protect yogins completely, to remove all obstructors, to remove all virulent diseases, to bring all virtuous qualities to completion, and to cast off all fear and terror."

The Blessed One (the Buddha) said: "Ānanda, this vidyā-mantra taught by the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is perfectly true. There is nothing untrue in it at all.

"If one wishes this bodhisattva to come into one's presence, one should enchant guggulu with the mantra twenty-one times and burn it, and the bodhisattva will come.

"If anyone has been seized by a cat graha, burn the skull of a cat, mix the ash with clean earth, and make the figure of a cat out of the clay. In front of the image of the Thousand-Eyed One, enchant a clean steel knife with the mantra one hundred and eight times, and cut the figure into one hundred and eight pieces, reciting the mantra once and uttering that one's name once for each piece. Then the person will be cured for good.

"If one has been struck by sorcery, take guggulu and camphor in equal parts, mix them with one measure of clean well water, and boil it down. Take what remains, about one handful, enchant it with the mantra one hundred and eight times in front of the image of the Thousand-Eyed One, and drink it, and one will recover.

"If one has been bitten by a scorpion or a snake, enchant powdered dried ginger with the mantra seven times and smear it on the wound, and one will recover at once.

"If malicious people secretly plot and do one harm, make a figure of the adversary out of clean earth, or flour dough, or beeswax. In front of the image of the Thousand-Eyed One, cut it with the steel knife one hundred and eight times, reciting the mantra once for each cut and uttering the adversary's name. When it has been made into one hundred and eight pieces and burned, the adversary will be pleased, and for as long as he lives he will honor one with respect and be loving.

"Those struck by eye disease, whose eyeballs are damaged, or who have become blind, or whose sight has grown unclear, or whose eyes are covered by white and red films so that they have no light, should take one fruit each of haritakī, bibhītaka, and āmalakī and grind them finely. Cleanliness must be kept while grinding, so women who have just given birth, dogs, and pigs should not be allowed near. Reciting the name of the Tathāgata, mix the powder with white honey and human milk and apply it to the eyes. The milk must be breast milk from a woman who has given birth to a boy; breast milk from a woman who has given birth to a girl is not suitable. Once the medicine is prepared, enchant it with the mantra one thousand and eight times in front of the image of the Thousand-Eyed One and apply it to the eyes. If one then stays in a secluded room for seven days, guarding against the wind, the eyeball will grow back, the blue and white films will be cleared away, and clear sight will increase.

"Those who have been struck by grahas and gone mad should enchant the skins of a tiger, a wild dog, and a wolf with the mantra twenty-one times and wear them on the body, and they will recover.

"If one has been bitten by a snake, take earwax from the person who was bitten, enchant it with the mantra twenty-one times, and put it on the wound as a patch, and the person will recover.

"If a malignant stabbing affliction pierces the heart and one is at the point of death, take a hand's measure of kabita, add one handful of clean water, and boil it down. Enchant the half handful that remains with the mantra seven times and give it to drink all at once, and the person will recover. This medicine should not be boiled in the presence of a woman.

"If one has been struck by a vetāla graha and has been ill for a long time, enchant guggulu with the mantra twenty-one times, burn it, and fumigate the nose with it. Or else take seven pellets of rabbit dung, enchant them with the mantra twenty-one times, and have them swallowed, and the person will recover. One must abstain from meat, alcohol, the five pungent foods, and harsh words. Or else enchant realgar, white mustard seed, and salt with the mantra twenty-one times and burn them beside the sick person's bed. Then the body of that graha will be destroyed, and, unable to bear staying, it will flee.

"If one side of the body is afflicted and the ears and nose are blocked, or one cannot draw in the hands and feet, boil costus in sesame oil, enchant it with the mantra twenty-one times, and smear it on the body, and the person will be cured for good. Or else, if one enchants cow's butter with the mantra twenty-one times and smears it on the body, one will also recover.

"If childbirth is difficult, enchant sesame oil with the mantra twenty-one times and smear it on the navel and vagina of the pregnant woman, and she will give birth quickly.

"For pregnant women whose child has died in the womb, boil one srang of giusi in two handfuls of water. Enchant the one handful that remains with the mantra twenty-one times and give it to drink. Then the suffering will be calmed, and the child will come out without pain. If the afterbirth will not come out, drinking this medicine will also help.

"If a sudden pain stabs the heart and it is unbearable, this is what is called the stabbing affliction of a corpse-wanderer. Enchant kunduru and white resin that has not been crushed with the mantra twenty-one times, give as much as is available, and have it chewed, and the person will recover. One must abstain from meat, alcohol, and the five pungent foods.

"If one has been burned by fire, enchant warm cow dung with the mantra twenty-one times and smear it on the wound, and one will recover.

"If worms have entered the belly and cause pain, enchant half a handful of the urine of a white horse with the mantra twenty-one times and give it to drink, and the person will recover. In a severe case, give a full handful to drink, and the worms will come out of themselves like a twisted rope.

"When a great boil has appeared, enchant the juice of pounded lengsé'u hā with the mantra twenty-one times and pour it on the boil. Its root will be drawn

out, and one will recover immediately.

If a fly gets into the eye and it becomes painful, take the juice squeezed from donkey dung, recite the mantra over it twenty-one times, and pour it into the eye at night; the eye will recover.

If the stomach aches, put twenty-one granules of unground salt into pure well water, recite the mantra over it twenty-one times, and drink half a handful; it will help.

If the eyes have become dim, if excess flesh has grown in the eye, or if a cataract has formed, pound leaves of the lycium tree and squeeze out the juice, and recite the mantra over it seven times. Leave a bronze coin in it for one day and one night, then recite the mantra over it seven times more and pour it into the eyes; they will recover.

If at night, when going out and coming in, one is frightened and alarmed and ill at ease, recite the mantra twenty-one times over a white thread, tie twenty-one knots in it, and fasten it around the neck; one will be free of fear and alarm. Not only will one be free of fear, one will also gain merit, and one's misdeeds will be purified.

If inauspicious omens appear in the household, take a branch of the pomegranate tree and cut it into one thousand and eight pieces. Smear both ends of each with butter and curd, and recite the mantra once as each piece is burned, until all one thousand and eight are complete; all grahas and obstructors will then be pacified. This must be done in the presence of a buddha.

Take white sweet flag, recite the mantra over it one hundred and eight times, and tie it to the right upper arm; one will be victorious wherever one fights in battle or speaks in dispute.

Take leaves or branches of the lycium tree, either will do, and cut them into pieces. Smear both ends with pure butter, white honey, and curd, and recite the mantra once as each piece is burned, until one thousand and eight are complete. This should be done at three times in a single day, and at each time the mantra should also be recited one thousand and eight times. When seven days are complete, that mantra practitioner will himself attain the higher knowledges (abhijñā).

If one wishes to subdue a mighty graha, recite the mantra forty-nine times over lungtang wood, smear it with butter and honey, and burn it before an

image of the Noble One Endowed with Great Compassion.

Put one tael of bezoar into a beryl vase, place it before an image of the Noble One Endowed with Great Compassion, and recite the mantra over it one thousand and eight times. If one smears it on the body or marks the forehead with it, all gods, nāgas, ghosts and demons, humans and nonhumans will be greatly delighted.

If someone has been thrown into prison, recite the mantra one hundred and eight times over the dung of a white pigeon, smear it on the hands, and rub it on the fetters; one will be freed from the fetters.

If husband and wife do not get along, like water and fire, take the tail feathers of a mandarin duck, recite the mantra over them one thousand and eight times before an image of the Noble One Endowed with Great Compassion, and tie them on the body. As long as they live, they will delight in each other and hold each other in loving-kindness and respect.

If insects get into the crops and fruits and eat them, take clean earth, ash, or sand, recite the mantra over it one thousand and eight times, and scatter it in the four directions of the field; the insects will scatter and leave. Recite the mantra over pure water and sprinkle it on the fruit trees; the insects will be unable to eat the fruit.

namo ratna trayāya śara mahāśara tulu mahātulu oṃ kume haniśapa oṃ kume haniśapa

The Blessed One said: "If anyone goes to a place where grain is scarce, and famine strikes and food runs out, you should close your eyes, hold your body straight, recite this dhāraṇī-mantra one hundred and eight times with a single-pointed mind, and open your eyes. The gods will come bringing vessels filled with divine food of a hundred flavors.

"If it is needed while one is living at home, place a clean, empty vessel in front, close the eyes, fill the mouth with water, and spray it onto a willow twig, a yak-tail whisk, and an alms bowl. When the spraying is done, close the eyes and recite this dhāraṇī forty-nine times. Food of a hundred flavors will appear of its own accord, filling all the vessels. Take it and eat it for seven days. Thus one should understand that the power of this dhāraṇī is inconceivable. When the meal is finished, close the eyes, say sarakha, and discard the leftover food as well. Once the food is eaten and swallowed, it is quickly digested, so that one gains strength and well-being, and one gains unobstructed eloquence.

"Ānanda, this is the dhāraṇī for retaining what one has heard:

namo buddhāya namo dharmāya namaḥ saṃghāya namaḥ ādanniya ugcidu ugcidu matilalila lalutenamanimitinama svāhā

"One who holds this dhāraṇī should make a maṇḍala on a mountain peak cut off on all four sides, set the boundaries, and protect the body. Fill a small bronze bowl with pure well water, place it in front, and recite the dhāraṇī-mantra. Without doubt a bright star will come. When it comes, do not give rise to fear; settle the mind at ease in meditative equipoise and recite the dhāraṇī-mantra with a single-pointed mind. One's faculties will become sharp and one will be endowed with wisdom, so that there is nothing one does not know, and among the dharmas of the worldly path, too, there is nothing one does not understand. Throughout this practice of hearing, one should cultivate the perception that a supremely bright star is coming into the water in the bowl."

The Dhāraṇī of the Vast, Perfectly Complete, Unobstructed Great Compassion of the Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. Second fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, respectfully joined his palms and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One (the Buddha), through the causes and conditions of the inconceivable merit I gathered in the past, today the Blessed One has made a prophecy concerning me. Having given rise to great compassion, I wish to benefit all sentient beings, to cut every bond without exception, and to bring all fears to rest. Therefore today I wish to explain the dhāraṇī called the Mother. Through the power of the blessing of hearing this dhāraṇī called the Mother, all the sentient beings of the final age will be freed from the causes of suffering and will attain the fruit of happiness.

"Blessed One, in the final five hundred years, in any country, village, town, or market town whatsoever, if monks, nuns, sons of good family, daughters of good family, and others constantly, six times throughout the day and night, read, recite, and uphold in accordance with the Dharma this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī-mantra called the Mother, then I, in order to remember and repay the kindness of the Tathāgata, will always follow those persons, protect them, and never abandon them, so that no spirits or demons will harm them. Moreover, all the heavy obscurations of their lifetimes will be purified at once, and all the Dharma gateways of the maṇḍalas and mudrās of the dhāraṇī-mantras will also be swiftly perfected."

He spoke further to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, the sentient beings of the final five hundred years to come will for the most part be thick with the stains of evil and slight in merit, so that even if there is someone who upholds this, spirits and demons will harm them. Therefore today, through the blessing of the Blessed One, I wish to explain the Dharma of the dhāraṇī in order to benefit sentient beings vastly, to bring happiness to sentient beings, and for the sake of gods, asuras, and others. Throughout as many past eons as cannot be measured, I have relied upon this Dharma of the dhāraṇī and made offerings to it. The buddhas of the past, the future, and those dwelling at present have also all attained unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening by means of this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī called the Mother.

"Therefore, if any son or daughter of good family recites, reads, and upholds this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī called the Mother with a one-pointed mind, then in this very life they will gain swift and unobstructed eloquence of speech and will realize wisdom and eloquence, and so they will become supreme among great assemblies of gods and humans. All who hear them will rejoice greatly, and everyone will bow their heads and pay them homage. In all their births they will see the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Whatever they say, everyone will trust it and listen to them. All of this is the power of the blessing of the buddhas, the blessed ones; it is not their own power."

Then the Blessed One praised the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, saying, "Excellent, excellent, that you have spoken thus for the sake of benefiting gods, humans, asuras, and all the others, bringing them happiness, and purifying the paths of karma!" And he declared, "I too, today, sealing you with the seal of wisdom, shall make you never turn back from the various states of mind such as great loving-kindness and great compassion."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke again to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I remember that I have upheld this Dharma discourse of the dhāraṇī called the Mother since immeasurable past eons. When I was dwelling on Mount Potala, the king of the māras, accompanied by a great retinue of māras, set about disrupting my Dharma and preventing the words of the mantra from being accomplished. At that time I subdued the many māras with this dhāraṇī called the Mother, and they all scattered in every direction. Thus the power of this dhāraṇī should be known to be inconceivable."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, in order to benefit all sentient beings with loving-kindness and great compassion and to bring happiness to gods and humans, spoke, before the Blessed One and the great gathered assembly, this mantra of the great body of the dhāraṇī called the Mother of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara who has a thousand arms and a thousand eyes:

namaḥ sarba tathāgatāya namo ratna trayāya namo'mitābhāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya nama āryābalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya namo mahāsthāma praptāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya namo bipula bimana supratiṣṭhita saṃghāya sūrya śata sahasra atireka prabhā ababhāsitermūrtaye mahāmaṇi makuṭa kuṇḍalālaṃkāra dhāraṇī bhagabate padmapāṇaye sarba loka upāśamanāya bibidha mukha samabeṣa biṣṭa sarba satva parimocakāya tadyathā oṃ bhurbhuba mahāloka karaṇa nātha ma siddhe mira bhadra bināśanā karāya rāga dveṣa moha jvala śamaka śasaka samāśvāsana karaka sarba pāpa durgate praśamana karāya sarba tathāgata sambadana kara he he mahābodhisatva barada padma loka saṃbhūta mahākāruṇika jaṭa mukuṭālaṃkṛta śarīraṃ maṇi kanaka śata bajra baiḍūryālaṃkṛta śareraṃ amitābha sina kamalālaṃkṛta prabharaṇa laricana mahāduna nara nari śata sahasra abhilaṣīta kāya mahābodhisatvāya bidhama bidhama bināśaya bināśaya mahāyantri kleśa kabadha ababadha bibidha satva saṃsāra cāraka pramathāna puruṣa padma puruṣa nāga puruṣa sāgara puruṣa siṃha bīra bīrāśāya suyanta suyanta bara bara dhama dhama sama sama dhuru dhuru praśāsaya praśāsaya giri giri biri biri ciri ciri muru muru muyu muyu muya muya muñca muñca dhuna dhuna bidhuna bidhuna dhuru dhuru gāya gāya gādhaya gādhaya hasa hasa prahasa prahasa bibhidha kleśa bāsana of me, named so-and-so, hara hara saṃhara saṃhara duruti duruti mahāmantra duruti karṇṇa śata parasika bhaba bisana śamaka mahābodhisatva barada svāhā

At that moment, as soon as the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, had spoken to the Blessed One this dhāraṇī called the Mother of the Jewel-Arrayed Staff in the Great Lotus Hand, everything from the great trichiliocosm up to the abode of the gods of neither perception nor non-perception shook in six ways and shook violently. The gods, too, let fall a rain of jewel flowers. The gods of Akaniṣṭha and the Maheśvaras also trembled and grew uneasy, and they became utterly terrified and alarmed. All the yakṣas, rākṣasas, and malevolent spirits and grahas let out great cries as they underwent great suffering, and they scattered east and west and fled; yet they

could neither know nor find any place to go.

Then he declared to the many emanated bodhisattvas of the retinue and to all the malevolent spirits and rākṣasas: "Whoever transgresses my vidyā-mantra and does not follow it, all the major and minor limbs of their bodies will be racked with pain and destroyed. This vidyā-mantra crushes mountains and dries up the great ocean. It routs the armies of the asuras and defeats them. It fully protects regions, villages, cities, and market towns. It defeats and thoroughly pacifies spirits and grahas, diseases, concocted poisons, the venom of insects and vermin, and perverse and malevolent people. It tames the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and makes them thoroughly subdued."

When he had said this, the Blessed One, who was dwelling in the great vajra palace of Supreme Joy, together with the supremely venerable bodhisattvas and the entire immeasurable assembly of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, kinnaras, and others who abide in the Buddha's Dharma, all at once spoke words of praise.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara again said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this vidyā-mantra utterly crushes even the exceedingly vast mountain of obscurations. Therefore, if anyone hears it, reads it, recites it, keeps it, or even sees it, whatever black obscurations of affliction they have will all melt away.

"Furthermore, if anyone always rises early in the morning and with a reverent mind reads or recites this mother dhāraṇī twenty-one times, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara himself will always follow that person, guarding and protecting them completely.

"If anyone wishes to swiftly accomplish great aspirations and all the great doors of meditative absorption, they should go alone to a secluded place, keep the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara in mind without attending to anything else, and constantly recite this dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times. Then there will be no aspiration whatsoever that is not fulfilled. Furthermore, they will become dear to the hearts of all sentient beings and will not fall through any of the doors to the lower realms.

"Whether an image is present or not, if one constantly maintains the perception that the Buddha is seated before one, then whatever evil karma that person has accumulated over immeasurable hundreds of thousands of koṭis of births will all melt away. That person will enjoy the perfect merit of a thousand universal monarchs. In every birth they will be born at the same time

as the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, and they will be born into noble families.

"If anyone constantly scatters incense or a handful of flowers before an image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and recites this dhāraṇī twenty-one times, they will obtain the good qualities of the great thousandfold world system and the very nature of great compassion. That person will, in due course, swiftly attain great power in the world."

If anyone constantly gazes at the bodhisattva's face, his eyes, his major marks and his minor marks, and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara will quickly show his body directly and be seen by the yogin. Being thereby freed from stains, that person will attain the first ground and the samādhi of recollecting the Buddha, and so will illuminate the world-realms with light. At the time of death he will die as though entering the equipoise of meditative concentration and samādhi, and so in all his lives he will attain the wisdom that recollects former existences. All his wrongdoing and misdeeds whatsoever will also melt away and be purified.

One who wishes to fully retain this dhāraṇī should always, in the first month of spring, the middle month of summer and the last month of autumn, from the first to the tenth day of the month, keep the poṣadha and moral discipline and wear clean white clothes. Eating the three white foods, he should make a square maṇḍala one cubit across out of white sandalwood paste before a stūpa containing relics, or before relics. He should scatter various kinds of flowers and incense within the maṇḍala, burn incense before an image of the Tathāgata, and fill lamps with butter. Giving rise to a reverent mind toward the buddhas and bodhisattvas, he should constantly recite this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times. If he does so, on the evening of the fifteenth day the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara himself will come into the maṇḍala. As soon as the yogin sees him, all the obscurations of extremely grave wrongdoing, such as the five acts of immediate retribution, will melt away and be purified, and all the actions of his body, speech and mind will be completely purified. Thereby he will also obtain the power of the Buddha's samādhi, the power of the ground of empowerment, the power of the ground of the perfections, and especially exalted wisdom.

Blessed One, if one wishes to bring down rain from the sky, one should gaze up at the sky and recite this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times; then a rain of sweet dew will fall in its proper season. If one gazes at farmland and recites this dhāraṇī a full one thousand and eight times, all the various kinds of grain

will flourish. If one recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times beside a river or spring that has dried up, its water will increase and swell.

In the presence of anyone stricken by fever, one should enchant one's own hand seven times with this mantra and stroke them with that hand; they will live. If one recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times in the presence of someone whose memory has failed, he will regain true memory. If, in the presence of those tormented by hunger and thirst, one gazes at their faces and recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times, all their painful perceptions of being tormented by hunger and thirst will be completely dispelled.

Those who wish to seal a boundary should enter the water of a pond, write this dhāraṇī out in full according to the Dharma, and fasten it to the top of a victory banner. Then for a hundred leagues around there will be no grahas or obstructors whatsoever; the boundary will be sealed and the area fully protected.

If any son or daughter of good family constantly recites this dhāraṇī one thousand and eight times each day, the merit of that person cannot be expressed. Such holders of the vidyā-mantra will become venerable and possessed of sovereignty. Moreover, all the multitudes of people will love them and serve them with honor, and their aspirations will be fulfilled exactly as they wish.

Those who wish to subdue māras should recite this Mother dhāraṇī and enchant guggulu twenty-one times with the mantra. Then, reciting the mantra once and burning once, they should complete one hundred and eight times; the māras will be completely dispelled.

If one wishes all the multitudes of people to be pleased, one should always enchant willow twigs twenty-one times with the mantra and fasten them above the doorway; then everyone will love and honor one.

Those who wish themselves to be endowed with eloquence and wisdom should grind one measure of sweet flag into powder, mix it with liquid butter and honey, and make pills. With this Mother dhāraṇī one should enchant them with the mantra until three signs appear, namely warmth, smoke and light. Having obtained those signs, one should each day eat seven pills of medicine, and also smear the heart with them. If one eats them in this way for a hundred days, one will obtain unobstructed eloquence. To protect one's own body, one should each day recite this Mother dhāraṇī one hundred and eight times and

also perform the twelve kinds of mudrā.

Of these, the first, the mudrā that gathers the whole body of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes, is this. First rise and stand up, hold the body straight, place the two feet side by side, and bend the right leg slightly. First stretch the left hand downward, bend the middle and ring fingers and place them in the palm, extend the little finger, index finger and thumb outward, and turn the palm so that it faces upward. After that, do the same with the right hand, bending the middle finger; hold it level with the shoulder with the palm facing forward. This is called the mudrā that gathers the whole body. If one wishes to destroy the dense thicket of wrong views of the māras and the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and lead them onto the true path, one should perform this mudrā and recite the mantra twenty-one times; then without doubt it will be accomplished as one wishes. The dhāraṇī is this:
namo ratnatrayāya nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya tadyathā avatta avatta parivatte ehi ehi svāhā

Of these, the second, the mudrā of the Total Retention dhāraṇī of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes, is this. As in the preceding mudrā that gathers the whole body, join the palms and place them at the heart. Interlace the five fingers, the left pressing down on the right. Raise the two index fingers straight up so that their tips meet. Press the two thumbs against the first joint of the two index fingers and part them slightly. This is called the mudrā of the Total Retention dhāraṇī.

If one performs this mudrā, all the evil karma of saṃsāra whatsoever, accumulated over immeasurable eons, will be completely purified at once. In times to come, one will be born in the pure buddhafields of the ten directions. When the Blessed One Śākyamuni was close to manifest, complete awakening, the king of the māras sought an opportunity to harm him, and by performing this mudrā of the Total Retention dhāraṇī he attained the supremely blissful meditative concentration and meditative absorption. The dhāraṇī is as follows:
tadyathā sarvadhāraṇī maṇḍala ehi ehi prabhāśuddha satvāya svāhā

Next, the third, the mudrā of the liberation, meditative concentration and meditative absorption of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes, is this. Again, drape the upper robe over one shoulder and place the right kneecap on the ground. Join the palms at the crown of the head, bend the two index fingers and bring their tips together, and press the two thumbs down on top of the second joint of the index fingers. This mudrā of the Dharma is called

the mudrā of liberation, meditative concentration and meditative absorption. All the tathāgatas of the past, too, attained meditative concentration, meditative absorption and liberation by accomplishing this Dharma. The vidyā-mantra is the same as before. Whoever performs this mudrā every day and makes offerings will swiftly see the buddhas of the ten directions.

Next, the fourth, the mudrā of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes, is this. Rise and stand upright with the two feet together. First join the backs of the middle fingers, ring fingers and little fingers, raise the two index fingers and bring their tips together, and press the two thumbs down on top of the second joint of the index fingers. Opening a space of about five finger-widths between the two hands, place them at the point between the eyebrows. This is called the mudrā endowed with a thousand eyes. If one performs this Dharma gate of the mudrā, one will see some hundred thousand times ten million excellent world realms of pure buddhafields, and from each of those buddhafields one million four thousand bodhisattvas will become companions to that yogin. Those who have not entered the Dharma gate of the maṇḍala three times may not even see this Dharma gate of the mudrā, nor may they perform this rite. But if one is a bodhisattva who has seen the signs and possesses clear superknowledge of Dharma and wisdom, then whatever one aspires to will all be fulfilled. The dhāraṇī is as follows: oṃ sarva cakṣuḥkrāya dhāraṇī indrāya svāhā

Next, the fifth, the mudrā of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes that gathers all the thousand hands, is this. Rise and stand with the feet together. First stretch out the palm of the right hand and bring the five fingers close against one another. After that, press the palm of the left hand down on top of the right and place them at the heart. This is called the mudrā that gathers all the thousand hands. By it, all the māras there are in the great trichiliocosm world system are gathered and subdued. The dhāraṇī-mantra is as follows: tadyathā avalokiteśvarāya sarva duṣṭa ohāyani svāhā

Next, the sixth, the mudrā by which one comes to realize the meditative absorption of the thousand-eyed bodhisattva, is this. Stand upright with the two heels together. First raise the fingers of the left hand, bend the middle finger, and extend it forward. After that, do the same with the right hand, bend the middle finger, and extend it inward. This is called the mudrā of coming to realize meditative absorption. By it one will realize meditative absorption, the array of the mudrās of wisdom, and the eighty-four thousand gates of the Dharma, and will also actualize unsurpassed, perfect and complete

awakening. One should recite the same vidyā-mantra as before.

Next, the seventh, the mudrā by which the thousand-eyed bodhisattva summons and gathers the eight classes of gods and nāgas, and the spirits and demons, is this. Standing upright, put the two feet together. First, with the ring finger of the left hand, touch the nail of the thumb. After that, do the same with the right hand. Raise the little fingers and middle fingers straight up and bring their tips together, join the two wrists, and interlace the index fingers with one another. The vidyā-mantra is as follows: oṃ sarva deva nāga anari svāhā

Next, the eighth, the mudrā by which the thousand-eyed bodhisattva invites Mahābrahmā and Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, and asks them about the Dharma, is this. From the previous mudrā, separate the two wrists, join the edges of the hands, turn the palms upward, and move the index fingers back and forth toward each other. The vidyā-mantra is as follows: oṃ mahābrahmāya ehi ehi svāhā By this mudrā and vidyā-mantra, all the immeasurable and countless gates of the mudrās of dhāraṇī are fully gathered and assembled. If an eclipse of the sun or moon occurs, one should empower ghee with the mantra one hundred and eight times, or else recite the mantra twenty-one times. If one eats the ghee sealed with the mudrā, one's faculties will become sharp, so that in a single day one will learn ten thousand ślokas. This Dharma gate of the mudrā was taught by the Tathāgata Sūryagarbha to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara.

Next, the ninth, the mudrā of the joyful wish-fulfilling jewel of the thousand-eyed bodhisattva, is this. Standing upright, join the palms at the heart. Bend both thumbs into the palms and raise the other four fingers straight up. If, with the palms joined at the heart, one recites the previous vidyā-mantra, one will without doubt enter the celestial palaces of the gods, roam throughout the buddhafields of the ten directions, obtain eight thousand jewels just as one wishes, and make offerings to the buddhas.

Whoever practices this gateway of the Dharma should rise early in the morning and bathe thoroughly. If one then forms this mudrā, one will directly see buddhas of the ten directions as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, and the heavy misdeeds of evil karma committed in saṃsāra over countless eons will be completely purified. For that reason such praise of its qualities is spoken.

The tenth, the mudrā of the thousand-eyed bodhisattva by which aspirations are fulfilled as one wishes, is this. Form the mudrā as before, then bend the two index fingers and press them on the nails of the two thumbs, placing the nails of the index fingers back to back. The vidyā-mantra to be recited is the same as before. If this is done, one's aspirations will be fulfilled, and without doubt one will not turn back from the path of awakening.

The eleventh, the mudrā of the samādhi of the absorption of cessation of the thousand-eyed bodhisattva, is this. Form the mudrā as before, then raise the five fingers straight and open the palms. This mudrā was given to me, when long ago I dwelt on the causal stage, by buddhas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges, and through it the path of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening became manifest to me. The vidyā-mantra to be recited is the same as before.

The twelfth, the mudrā of the samādhi by which the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes invites the buddhas, is this. As in the previous mudrā, join the palms at the heart and move the two index fingers back and forth toward each other. The vidyā-mantra is this:
oṃ sarba buddha samaya ehi ehi brahma śuddha satva svāhā

Now, the rite of drawing the maṇḍala of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands is this. Blessed One, through this Dharma of the maṇḍala, the vidyā-mantra and the mudrā of the Mother endowed with great miraculous power, in the final age the vidyā-holders will swiftly and clearly behold all the samādhis of equality of the maṇḍala of the dhāraṇī-mantras of the vidyā-mantras of the tathāgatas. Therefore whoever is a person who holds the vidyā-mantra should always restrain speech and should not engage in idle talk. Whatever miraculous powers, samādhis and various wondrous signs arise from the dhāraṇī should not be recounted carelessly and without examination. With a mind of complete clear faith, one should establish mindfulness and not be distracted even for an instant.

If, out of craving for gain, one outwardly displays various signs to others, then even though one wishes to purify one's evil karma, these aims will not be accomplished. If one does not meditate with genuine clear faith and an intention directed to the Dharma, all that one does will be wasted, and one will merely undergo various sufferings to no purpose, while the practices will never come to fruition. Therefore, always guarding moral discipline in complete purity with earnest diligence, one should not eat the five pungent foods, nor

meat, nor drink alcohol.

If one speaks divisive words, deceitful words or envious words, or if these faults of stealing the rites of the maṇḍala, the mudrās and the vidyā-mantras occur, all the buddhas and bodhisattvas will forsake that person and will say, "Although I have not abandoned you, you are not fit to be looked upon and taken into my care." For, Blessed One, such persons destroy the pure moral discipline of all the tathāgatas, and they denigrate and ruin the Three Jewels, the true Dharma and all the characteristics of virtue. Therefore such persons are always gathered into one realm with the māra who is a son of the gods, with all spirits and grahas, with the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and with the vināyakas; they dwell in one and the same karma and become forever without refuge. Hence the noble ones do not protect them, and it should be known that they are always cursed by all the buddhas, bodhisattvas, noble ones, gods and sages.

Even if such persons, who disparage the path and destroy the Dharma, constantly recollect this dhāraṇī day and night, Blessed One, I see that they will never attain accomplishment. And that failure to accomplish is not my fault; it is their own fault. For this reason they are not to be allowed to see or hear the rite of this dhāraṇī and these volumes, nor are they to be granted permission to recite and hold them. For when those who guard pure celibate conduct, who are endowed with loving-kindness and a mind of compassion, who are tender toward sentient beings and who strive for awakening, write it down in letters, and read, recite and fully uphold it, the maṇḍala of the dhāraṇī of the Mother will be accomplished.

Since this rite of the Dharma is the supremely secret heart of the bodhisattva mahāsattva Avalokiteśvara, the vidyā-holder, with a genuine mind and a mind of diligence, should even give up his limbs and minor limbs, bones, flesh, sinews, marrow, head, eyes and so forth, giving them to others, in order to seek this Dharma. If one wishes always to practice it with earnest diligence, what need is there to mention giving away jewels, grain, silk brocade, clothing, bedding, medicine and all kinds of wealth for the sake of the Dharma of the dhāraṇī, the maṇḍala and the mudrā images of the Mother of liberation? One should practice single-pointedly, just as the master has taught.

Why is that? Because, at the final time to come, this Dharma of the dhāraṇī of liberation performs the deeds of a buddha for sentient beings. It brings about right conduct, right action, right effort, the factors one advances through by

view, and the path of liberation, and it ensures that from this time until they fully awaken into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they will never turn back.

That maṇḍala may be made inside a temple, on a mountain, beside a flowing spring, or near a forest. All around, to a depth of one cubit or more, one should dig out and remove whatever is there: tree roots, bad soil, potsherds, pebbles, bones and so on. One should take good soil to a foundation of about one cubit, pound it and make it level. Cow dung and scented water should be mixed with yellow earth to make a clay, and the ground should be smeared with it well and plastered smooth. It should then be divided into five enclosures.

The central enclosure should be made about three cubits wide. In its very center one should draw a jewel wheel, two cubits across and perfectly square, with one hundred and eight spokes. Furthermore, in the center of the wheel one should draw an open jewel lotus with thirty-two petals, one cubit in size. Furthermore, blazing light should be drawn around the outer rim of the wheel. After that, one should draw an open lotus at each of the four corners of the enclosure. Furthermore, on each lotus one should draw a wish-fulfilling jewel, and above the four jewels draw blazing light. Furthermore, on the lotus with thirty-two petals one should place a figure of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara made of white sandalwood.

Then the second enclosure should be made one cubit wide, and, as before, an open lotus should be drawn at each of the four corners. Furthermore, on each of those lotuses one should draw three Mount Meru seats of three tiers each. On the seat of the northeast one draws the god Maheśvara (Śiva). On the seat of the southeast one draws the god Mahābala. On the seat of the southwest one draws Mahābrahmā. On the seat of the northwest one should draw Śakra (Indra). Furthermore, on the four sides one should draw jewel flowers and sixteen garlands.

Then the third enclosure should be made two cubits wide, and on a blue ground one should draw nothing but stretched golden lines.

Then the fourth enclosure should be made one cubit wide. Its four sides together are divided into twenty-eight compartments, and in each compartment one should draw an open lotus. Furthermore, in order, on each of those lotuses one should draw separately the emblems of the vajra mallet, the trident, the battle-axe, the knife, the sword, the conch, the curved blade, the noose, the one holding a staff, the parasol, the wish-fulfilling jewel, the

staff of Yama, the vināyaka, the weapon, the wheel, and the one with various arms and hands, and on all those emblems one should draw blazing light. Furthermore, in the compartment at the southern gate one draws the god Yāma. In the compartment at the western gate one draws Varuṇa. In the compartment at the northern gate one draws Kubera. In the compartment at the eastern gate one should draw the god Kumāra. Then at each of the four corners one should draw the Four Great Kings, frowning in wrath, together with their attendants.

Then the fifth enclosure should be made one cubit wide, and all around its four sides one should draw fruit trees, flowering trees, and jewel trees of many kinds. Furthermore, at each of the four corners one should draw a jewel Mount Meru. At the four gates one should draw the waters of the great ocean. The ground of the inner enclosures of the maṇḍala should be made blue. Furthermore, at the corner on the southern side of the western gate of the inner enclosures, one should open a gate through which the mantra practitioner comes and goes.

Furthermore, a made image of Avalokiteśvara with a thousand eyes and a thousand arms should be hung in the center, facing east. Furthermore, a volume of the sūtra of the thousand eyes and thousand arms should be placed upon the maṇḍala of the thirty-two-petaled lotus. In front of that image one should then arrange sixteen bowls of white sandalwood scented water; various kinds of food; the three white foods; twenty-five basins filled with fruits and the like; one measure of scented water; twenty-five vases adorned at the mouth with silks of various colors, flowers, branches of trees and so on; twenty each of the various kinds of flowers and garlands; twenty-eight lamps; twenty portions of ointment, incense powder and other incenses; and banners painted with images of bodhisattvas and banners made of silks of various colors, twenty-five strings in all.

The plates, vessels, vases and all the other things used for making these offerings should be made of gold, silver, bell metal and the like. If genuine ones are not available, imitations may also be used. In this way, all these implements should be drawn and arranged according to the Dharma on the four sides of the inner enclosures. Seats should be set out, and various flowers arranged and scattered. Puffed śāli rice, white mustard seed, and many kinds of flowers should be scattered over the maṇḍala. The foods as well should be offered every day from good, freshly prepared ones. And whenever the mantra practitioner comes and goes, he should bathe and purify himself completely,

anoint himself with ointment, and put on new, clean clothes.

Having eaten the three white foods, one should mix sandalwood, aloeswood, turuṣka incense, camphor and the like, and three times in a single day make offerings to the image that has been made of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, endowed with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands. Inside the third inner enclosure, in front of where the thousand-eyed image has been placed, one should pledge to take up the three bodhisattva vows correctly. Day and night, sitting cross-legged at the western water gate of the outer enclosure, one should recite the dhāraṇī of the Mother one thousand and eight times a day without interruption, and for twenty-one days one should make offerings with one-pointed intent.

Furthermore, at the six times of day one should enter the maṇḍala through the water gate at the western corner of the maṇḍala and stand at the western water gate of the third enclosure. One should perform all the mudrās taught before, the first, the second, the third, and so on up to the twelfth, the samādhi of inviting the buddhas, and recite the mantra seven times for each. Having performed them up to the twelfth mudrā, one makes the aspiration, "May I never turn back from the utterly firm aspiration for great awakening." When one then performs the invitation, all will draw near. So one should sit with the body held straight, and with a resolute mind, shutting out all gods and spirits and making no offerings to them, one should fix the perception that he is present before one's eyes. Without focusing on any other object, one recites the earlier mantra of the Great Body twenty-one times. That night a great light will come forth from the image that has been made, and the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara himself will without doubt show his body directly. Having shown his body, when he comes he will emanate a bodily form delightful to all, and with a joyful, smiling face he will ask the yogin, "What do you need? What do you wish for?" At that time the mantra practitioner should answer in these words: "I seek unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening; I pursue the Dharma of dhāraṇī and samādhi; and furthermore I seek the accomplishment of all the rites of maṇḍala, mudrā and mantra, and that all spirits and grahas be tamed and heed my word." Even when these wishes have been accomplished, one should know it oneself and not speak of it to others.

This maṇḍala rite may also be performed by drawing it on woolen cloth or on dyed cloth.

If one wishes all one's wishes to be accomplished, one should make a square water maṇḍala, burn aloeswood, recite the earlier mantra of the Great Body one thousand and eight times, and perform the earlier tenth mudrā, by which wishes are accomplished as one desires. Then all wishes will be accomplished just as intended and fully completed.

If one wishes all of a great many people to be pleased, one should perform the earlier mudrā of the supremely joyful wish-fulfilling jewel and empower sesame seeds twenty-one times with the mantra of the Great Body. Or else, reciting the mantra once and casting the seeds into the fire once, completing one thousand and eight times, all will be pleased just as one wishes.

If one wishes the yakṣas to be pleased, one should take a branch from a tree in a yakṣa's park, empower it twenty-one times with the mantra, and leave it in the park. They will then be pleased.

If one wishes to subdue a savage person who has become an enemy, one should empower khongleng bok wood twenty-one times with the mantra, and, reciting the mantra once and casting once into the fire, complete one hundred and eight times. That person will come for refuge and be subdued.

If there is a spirit or graha that is hard to subdue, one should empower guggulu and white mustard seed twenty-one times with the mantra, and, reciting the mantra once and casting once into the fire, complete one hundred and eight times. Then all spirits and grahas will be subdued of themselves.

If an epidemic breaks out in a region, one should make a square water maṇḍala and empower good cow's butter one hundred and eight times with the mantra; then, reciting the mantra once and casting once into the fire, complete one thousand and eight times. All epidemics will then be pacified. Or else, if one takes a little water and gives it to someone struck by the epidemic to drink, that person will at once recover.

Long ago, in a land called Gebyin, an epidemic broke out, and those whom it struck met their death within no more than a day or two. At that time a brahmin called Cinti, in whom great compassion arose, set out this method of the rite and healed everyone in that whole country who had been struck by the epidemic, so that all were pacified. Because the king of spirits who spreads the epidemic then left that land, one should know that its medicinal benefit is great.

If one is oppressed by enemy armies, or if robbers and unrest arise, one should perform the first mudrā, which gathers the whole body, and recite the vidyā-mantra one hundred and eight times. Then all those enemies and robbers will be completely pacified of their own accord.

If any son or daughter of good family, through the power of karmic maturation, is near the end of their life, one should perform the earlier mudrā of the attainment of cessation, make offerings every day, burn aloeswood, and recite the vidyā-mantra one thousand and eight times. If, each time one recites the mantra once, one pronounces that person's name once, those karmic obscurations will be completely purified.

Long ago in Vārāṇasī there lived a householder who had only one son, and that son was not able to live beyond sixteen years. When he had reached fifteen, the householder and his wife lost their strength from grief. At that time a brahmin who went from door to door begging for food saw the householder and said, "Why are you unhappy?" The householder told him the whole story in detail.

Then the brahmin said to the householder, "Do not grieve. Do as I instruct you, and your son will have a long life." That brahmin then performed this very rite for a full seven days. Then Yama said to the householder, "Your son's lifespan could not go beyond sixteen years. He had reached fifteen, and only one year remained. But today, because he has met with a virtuous condition, he will be able to live a hundred years. For that reason I have come here to tell you."

At that, the householder and his wife were overjoyed and delighted. They gathered up all the wealth of their household and offered it to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. Therefore it should be understood that this rite has great and inconceivable power.

If someone has previously entered three times into the great assembly maṇḍala and the great vajra maṇḍala, no maṇḍala is needed. Merely by forming the mudrā and reciting the vidyā-mantra, there is none of one's wishes that will not be fulfilled, and one will also swiftly attain complete and perfect awakening.

If some woman suffers greatly in giving birth, ghee should be empowered with the mantra twenty-one times and given to her to take. She will then certainly be at ease. Whatever boys and girls are born will possess the excellent major and minor marks. Adorned with various virtues, by the power of merit gathered in the past, they will be dear to the hearts of many people. Always,

among humankind, they will enjoy the most exalted riches.

If some being is struck by eye disease and is in pain and distress, the mantra practitioner should form the mudrā of the bodhisattva with a thousand eyes, recite the mantra twenty-one times, and touch the eyes with the mudrā. The eyes will then be healed, and by that cause and condition the person will obtain the divine eye, clearly see the gods, and enjoy supreme riches.

The rite for painting the image of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands is as follows. Use white cloth sixteen cubits long, or twenty cubits will also do. Make the body of the bodhisattva the color of Jambu River gold. The face has three eyes. He has a thousand arms, and on the palm of each of those thousand arms an eye is painted.

The truly principal great arms are eighteen. First, two hands are joined palm to palm at the heart. One hand holds a vajra hammer. Another holds a trident. Another holds a book. Another holds a jewel seal. Another holds a monk's staff. Another holds a precious jewel. Another holds a precious wheel. Another holds an open lotus. Another holds a noose. Another holds a willow branch. Another emits rays of five-colored light. Another holds a rosary. Another holds a flask. Another is shown as the hand pouring forth sweet nectar. Another is shown as the hand that rains down various jewels and grants fearlessness. Two more rest at the level of the navel, the left pressed beneath the right, palms turned upward.

All the other nine hundred and ninety-two arms are emanated arms, and each of them holds various weapons and mudrās. Some versions have only eight hand mudrās, since they differ from one another. As it is said in the Essence Sūtra: "That bodhisattva wears a crown of the seven kinds of divine jewels. His forearms are adorned with various bracelets and armlets. On his body he wears garlands, and he is clad in splendid garments of divine jewels."

No hide glue should be put into the paints. They should be mixed with the juice of kunduru resin.

Those who wish to perform the rite of the mother dhāraṇī should first paint the image. The painting of the image must certainly be done in accordance with the Dharma. All around the house where the painting is done, the ground should be smeared with white sandalwood water and clay, and a maṇḍala made. Moreover, whenever the painter goes in or out, he should bathe and put on new, clean clothes, and each day he should properly take the eight vows.

Even after the image has been painted in accordance with the Dharma, if there is a suspicion that the painter did not do it properly, a square maṇḍala should be made according to one's inclination. Banners, flowers, food, the three white foods, flowers, garlands, scented water, and various flowers should be spread all about, and vast offerings made. Then the yogin and the painter, whoever they may be, should confess their faults before the painted image three times a day. On the night when twenty-one days are complete, a great light will issue from the painted image with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands, outshining the sun and moon. Its light will illuminate without obstruction all the endless and measureless world systems of the great trichiliocosm in the ten directions. Thereby the yogin and the painter, whoever they may be, and all beings touched by the light, will have whatever grave misdeeds they carry dissolve away all at once, and they will become completely pure. The only exception is whoever performs this rite without one-pointed concentration.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke again, saying:

"Long ago, in a past age, I saw the Tathāgata Vipaśyin also display these thousand hands and thousand eyes and subdue the great māras. Blessed One (the Buddha), today I too have displayed these thousand hands and thousand eyes and subdued the great māras. Each one of those thousand hands will emanate a wheel-turning king, and they will serve as the wheel-turning kings of the thousand generations of the Good Eon (Bhadrakalpa). Each one of those thousand eyes will emanate a buddha, and they will appear as the equals of the thousand buddhas of the Good Eon. For this reason, Blessed One, the body of this bodhisattva is supreme among those who subdue māras."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, "Excellent, excellent! I too, through the power of my blessing, shall bless this mother dhāraṇī of yours until the very end of the eon."

The Vast and Perfectly Complete Dhāraṇī of the Unimpeded Great Compassion of the Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. The third fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, hearing the praise spoken by the Blessed One, was overjoyed and delighted. He joined his palms, gazed at the face of the Blessed One, and said this: "Blessed One, there is, moreover, the accomplishment of the mudrā of the dhāraṇī endowed with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands."

The Blessed One said, "I too rejoice. Tell it."

Then the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke. When the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara spoke this vidyā-mantra, all the abodes of the gods throughout the great trichiliocosm, up to the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception, shook in six ways. The gods of Akaniṣṭha and Maheśvara (Śiva) too grew uneasy and were terrified. All the savage spirits and grahas experienced great suffering; crying out, they scattered east and west, and could find no place to go.

Then, with an emanated body, he commanded the great assembly and the savage spirits and grahas: "If you do not follow my vidyā-mantra and you transgress it, your heads will split into pieces."

"Blessed One, this vidyā-mantra shatters mountains and dries up the great oceans. This vidyā-mantra vanquishes the armies of the asuras and protects the lands. This vidyā-mantra cuts down all savage spirits and grahas, all diseases, and all savage people. This vidyā-mantra overpowers and tames the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three.

"If any son of good family recites and upholds this vidyā-mantra, the might and power of that person cannot be told. Those who recite and uphold this vidyā-mantra become dignified and endowed with wealth and authority; as long as they live they are loved by the king and held dear, and their aspirations are fulfilled.

"If anyone wishes to subdue hostile māras, he should burn guggulu incense and recite the mantra of my great body twenty-one times. If one wishes all people to love oneself, one should empower a willow twig with the mantra twenty-one times; if one places it at the doorway, one will be loved and honored. If one wishes oneself to have eloquence and wisdom, one should empower sweet flag with the mantra one thousand and eight times; if one smears it on the heart, one will obtain unimpeded eloquence. And one should form the mudrā of the essence of the mother dhāraṇī.

"Here, the mudrā of the unimpeded eloquence of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is this: join the two hands with their backs together and extend the two thumbs forward. This mudrā protects oneself and protects others as well.

"In whatever direction one may go, wishing to set a boundary, one should empower clean water or clean ash with the mantra seven times. At the place where one is staying, first scatter a handful of the water or ash over one's own

body, and afterward scatter it properly in the four directions; that very place will then be established as a boundary.

"If any son of good family or daughter of good family is tormented by savage spirits and rākṣasas and by many perverse grahas, take a branch of pomegranate and a branch of willow from the shady side, recite this vidyā-mantra, and strike the sick person with them; whatever the illness may be, there is none who will not recover. The vidyā-mantra is this:

namaḥ sarva buddha dharma saṃghāya nama āryā valokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya namo vajrapāṇaye bodhisatvāya tadyathā visi visi vi kāya sivi pala śa pala ni svāhā

"This mudrā of the vidyā-mantra tames the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) of wrong view.

"If any son of good family or daughter of good family always recites it twenty-one times at sunrise, at midday, and at sunset, this is no different from having made offerings of every kind to ten koṭis of buddhas; therefore such a one will never take on the state of a woman. After death, too, they will be parted forever from the three lower realms and will be born in the pure field of the Tathāgata Amitābha. That Tathāgata will stroke the crown of their head with his hand and say, 'You will be born in my field, so do not be afraid.' In this very life, too, they will not die an untimely death, and spirits and grahas will find no opportunity to harm them."

Now, this is the mudrā by which the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara purifies the misdeeds of the great thousand world system. Standing, extend the left hand forward like this, spread the five fingers apart, hold it out in front, and raise all five fingers. Next, bend the thumb of the right hand into the palm, close the other four fingers into a fist, and place it level with the right ear. Recite the mantra of the Great Body, and move the index finger back and forth. This mudrā should be performed three times in a single day. If, even at a single session, one recites seven times, the misdeeds of the five acts of immediate retribution and of the four very grave offenses will be purified. If one generates loving-kindness and compassion toward all sentient beings, the root of all misdeeds is burned away. After death one will meet the buddhas, and in those buddha fields one will become a wheel-turning king. Moreover, one will attain the dhāraṇī called Inexhaustible Treasure and the dhāraṇī called Equal Wisdom. Moreover, one will come to possess the twenty-eight marks. Moreover, in this very life one's eyes, ears, nose, tongue and so on will not

become impaired, and all diseases of the body will be completely cured. Past karma and misdeeds will also melt away and be purified.

If a drought occurs, mix sesame seeds with oil pressed from their fruit and make pills. Enchant them with the mantra one hundred and eight times and throw them into a pond, and rain will fall from the sky. If there is too much rain, mix pounded flowers of śāli rice with mustard-seed oil and make pills. Enchant them with the mantra one hundred and eight times and throw them into a pond, and the rain will stop.

Now, this is the mudrā by which the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara subdued the māras of the great trichiliocosm. Interlace the fingers, the left pressing down on the right, clench them firmly into a fist, and place it on the crown of the head. If one recites the mantra of the Great Body, all hostile enemies will be subdued of themselves.

Whoever performs this rite should, on the night of the twenty-ninth day, before a stūpa containing relics, make a maṇḍala of white sandalwood powder and scatter various flowers. Having bathed thoroughly and put on new, clean clothes, one should hold an incense bowl in the hand, burn aloeswood, face east, and sit cross-legged. One should visualize the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, endowed with a thousand hands and a thousand eyes, as present on the crown of one's head, and recite the mantra of the Great Body one thousand and eight times. This is the first and supreme benefit, through which accomplishment is attained.

Moreover, mix white mustard seed together with sesame seed, pound them into a powder, take a little with three fingers, enchant it once with the mantra, and cast it into the fire. Do this for seven full days, completing one hundred and eight times each day, and afterward whatever one wishes to do will be accomplished.

Now, this is the mudrā of the great fearlessness of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. Standing, press both feet firmly together. First press down with the right hand, raise the left forearm, and place it on the knee; do the same with the left hand. If one constantly recites the mantra of the Great Body one thousand and eight times before relics, one will swiftly attain the gateway of the samādhi that bestows fearlessness upon sentient beings.

Moreover, take pills of asafoetida, white mustard seed, sweet flag and tatapa, and cast these substances into the fire and burn them. These should be burned before an image of the Buddha, or in a maṇḍala, or in clean places,

while reciting the mantra of the Great Body: reciting the mantra once and burning once, until one hundred and eight are complete. Then, if one makes offerings of incense and flowers to the vidyā-mantra, whatever one wishes for will be accomplished just as one desires. If things that other vidyā-mantras cannot accomplish are enchanted with this mantra, all of them will be overcome and accomplished. If one wishes to see signs in dreams, recite this mantra, form the mudrā, and touch it to the eyes; whatever one wishes to see, all of it will be seen in dreams.

Those who lack merit, whose wishes for whatever they would do do not come about as they desire, should recite this vidyā-mantra one hundred and eight times every day; when seven full days are completed, they will obtain whatever they wish for.

Blessed One, formerly, when I was teaching the Dharma in the abode of the nāga king Sāgara, at the Dharma assembly of the ocean, I saw many nāgas experiencing great suffering. Out of compassion for those many nāgas, to free them completely from suffering, and so that many sentient beings would be parted from suffering and be without hostile enemies, I taught the Dharma. At that time a nāga daughter, seeking this Dharma, offered a precious jewel worth the whole Sahā world system, and when I taught her this mother dhāraṇī extensively, they were freed from the obstructors of suffering.

Then the bodhisattva Water Crystal, in order to benefit those who uphold this vidyā-mantra and to protect them completely from obstructors, spoke this mantra:

vimale mahāvimale uhale mahāuhale humale mahāhumale sahāle mahāsahāle cilite svāhā

"Whatever son or daughter of good family, in whatever direction they may dwell, upholds this Dharma rite of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes and a thousand hands, I too will always follow them and protect them completely, so that they will not be harmed by the obstacles of the retinues of Māra."

If anyone is troubled and destitute, or is harassed by foreign enemies, or is being harmed by bandits, one should enchant a thread of five colors twenty-one times with the mantra. Reciting the mantra once and tying one knot each time, one should tie it on the left upper arm. Furthermore, curl the ring finger, the middle finger, and the index finger of the left hand into a fist, press them from above with the thumb, and point the little finger toward the

bandits. If one recites this mantra one hundred and eight times, they will all scatter of their own accord and will not cause harm.

In the past, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara was dwelling on the Snow Mountain teaching the Dharma. He saw that the people living in the lands of the yakṣas and rākṣasas sought nothing but the flesh and blood of beings and had no virtuous thought whatsoever. At that time that bodhisattva, skilled in means, in order to benefit and tame beings, went at once to those lands by the power of his miraculous abilities. With a thousand eyes and a thousand hands he manifested a body that subdues māras, and made the mudrā that accomplishes the dhāraṇī of the Mother. At that time the king of the land of the rākṣasas came before me, confessed his misdeeds, and bowed down. I too sealed him with the accomplishing mudrā, and through this he accomplished the unsurpassed path.

The accomplishing mudrā of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara is this. Standing, place the two feet side by side, join the palms at the heart, cross the two little fingers, pressing the right with the left, and recite the mantra of the Great Body twenty-one times. Then, whatever various rites one performs, all of them will be accomplished.

Next, the wheel mudrā by which the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara completely protects the six classes of beings from the obstructions of suffering is this. If one wishes to completely protect the beings of the six destinies from suffering, one should employ the wheel mudrā, in this way: bring the tips of the ten fingers together, one against another, and keep the wrist joints and the palms apart. Leave a space of about a finger's breadth between the fingers as well. This is called "That bodhisattva, abiding in the six destinies, has completely passed beyond the obstructions of suffering," for by the power of this wheel mudrā all become free from suffering.

Next, the mudrā of complete and perfect awakening of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes is this. Sitting cross-legged, first stretch out the left hand, spread out all five fingers, and place it on the left knee. After that, stretch out the right hand, turn all five fingers face down, and press it upon the right knee. This resembles the mudrā of the absorption of cessation. Since all the buddhas of the past, of the future, and those dwelling at present likewise attain complete and perfect awakening through this mudrā, this mudrā clears away all karmic obscurations. Those yogins who practice meditative concentration and have not yet made samādhi directly manifest should go to a

solitary place for up to seven days and nights, recite this dhāraṇī, and perform this mudrā. With one-pointed mind they should bring to mind the buddhas as dwelling manifestly before their eyes, and confess six times in each day and night. Then the buddhas will become directly manifest to them, and they will also obtain great heaps of merit, measureless, incalculable, and inexpressible.

Next, the mudrā by which the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes summons the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three is this. First, curl the four fingers of the left hand into a fist. After that, with the right hand grasp the left thumb as though clenching it in a fist, let the tip of the left thumb protrude above the right fist, and move the index finger of the right hand back and forth. The mantra is this:
oṃ kuci kuci kuciyari cari cari carile svāhā

Because this mudrā and mantra of the dhāraṇī are inconceivable, if any son or daughter of good family, at the time of going to sleep, performs this mudrā, reciting this mantra once and making the mudrā at the heart once, until a full one hundred and eight times are complete, then whatever the mind desires will be known and seen in dreams. If anyone constantly performs this mudrā and recites this mantra, all wrongdoing will be purified and the awakening mind will never be lost. Therefore, when that person lies down to sleep at night, their dreams will be vast, flourishing, and auspicious. In dreams they will see the Tathāgata seated at the foot of the tree of awakening giving prophecies, and so on up to attaining complete and perfect buddhahood. Brahmā, Śakra, and the gods will always come near to them, serving them and protecting them.

Next, the mudrā by which the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes summons the gods, the nāgas, and the eight classes of spirits and demons is this. Standing, place the two feet side by side. First bend the thumb of the left hand into the palm, curl the four fingers into a fist, and place it at the heart. After that, do the same with the right hand, hold the right hand near the ear, and move the index finger back and forth. The mantra is this:
namo nīlakaṇṭha nama āryaśapata svāhā nama āryaśala svāhā ehi ehi svāhā

If any son or daughter of good family takes up, holds, reads, or recites this dhāraṇī and mudrā, they will quickly come to recollect the circumstances of their former existences as far back as seven lifetimes. They will not be seized by venomous snakes. Poison will not affect them. Weapons will not harm them. They will not be punished by the king. And never will they experience

the sufferings of the hell beings. If anyone recites this vidyā-mantra every day, the eight classes of spirits and demons will come near to the one reciting the vidyā-mantra and listen to the recitation.

If any son or daughter of good family is seized by a demonic graha, one should enchant a white thread with the mantra. Reciting the mantra once and tying one knot each time, one completes a full forty-nine knots. If the thread is then tied around that person's neck, their illness will be cleared away.

If in any land evil omens and epidemic disease arise, and many people of that land die, one should take one thousand and eight lotuses from the king's parks and ponds. One enchants each lotus with the mantra once, casts it into the fire and burns it, and the epidemic will be fully pacified.

The mudrā of liberation of the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes is this. Sitting in the cross-legged posture, one first joins the tip of the middle finger of the left hand to the tip of the thumb and presses them together. The other three fingers are extended, and the hand is placed on the left knee. After that, one does the same with the right hand, and places that hand face down on the right knee. Whoever constantly forms this mudrā and recites the Great Body mantra twenty-one times will have their aspirations completely fulfilled and will also be liberated from their sufferings.

Suppose some son or daughter of good family has committed various kinds of grave misdeeds, such as the ten nonvirtues and the five acts of immediate retribution. If all the earth there is in Jambudvīpa were ground into the finest particles, and each of those particles were to count for one eon, then by the force of having committed those various grave misdeeds, that person would fall into the hells for that many eons, experiencing suffering, with no time ever to escape. Even so, if that son or daughter of good family, before an image containing relics, on the fifteenth day of the bright fortnight, fasts for one day and night, forms the mudrā and recites the vidyā-mantra a full one thousand and eight times, all the sufferings described above will melt away and be purified. Should someone say that they would not be purified, there is no such possibility.

The mudrā by which the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, endowed with a thousand eyes, attained mastery over the bases of miraculous power is this. Rising and standing upright, one first grips the big toe of the left foot with the left hand, as though clenching a fist. After that, one presses the right hand on top of the left wrist. If one then recites the Great Body mantra seven times, even should

one wish to travel many hundreds of thousands of yojanas, it will be without difficulty. While reciting the mantra, one should not make a sound.

The mudrā by which the bodhisattva endowed with a thousand eyes attained mastery over miraculous power is this. First, one touches the thumb of the left hand to the nail of the little finger. After that, one does the same with the right hand, raises the other three fingers upward, each separately, joins the wrists together and places them on the crown of the head. If one recites the Great Body mantra one hundred and eight times, one will travel at will, like the sages who fly through the sky.

The mudrā for one-pointedly inviting the bodhisattvas is this. One joins the two palms together in the air, joining them at the wrists, and moves the two index fingers back and forth toward each other. The mantra is this:

oṃ arolikatele lokibidoya sarba yadru pramardhana karāya puru svāhā

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those great śrāvakas, those bodhisattvas, and the whole world with Great Brahmā, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called The Vast, Perfect, Unobstructed Mind of Great Compassion of the Bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara Endowed with a Thousand Arms and a Thousand Eyes, together with its ritual.

Translated from a Chinese manuscript and finalized by the great editor-translator, the monk Chödrup.

Translator's Notes

• This text is the Tibetan rendering of the Chinese Great Compassion Dhāraṇī Sūtra, and several names are reconstructed from the Chinese parallel. The bodhisattva names Dhāraṇīrāja, Bhaiṣajyasamudgata, Padmavyūha, Mahāvyūha and Śrīgarbha are reconstructions of this kind. The nāga king "Mountain Glory" and the goddess "Youthful Eyes" could not be identified with certainty, so their names are translated literally. The god names Kṣaṇḍamara and Kumbhaka are given as the Tibetan transliterates them.
• The name of the past buddha, "King of a Thousand Lights Abiding in Peace," is translated from its meaning, since no Sanskrit form can be identified with confidence. The Chinese version of this sūtra has the same name. The phrase rendered "passed straight on to the eighth ground" literally reads "passed beyond from the eighth ground." The Chinese parallel says he leapt directly to the eighth ground. "Eight hundred million eons" renders the Tibetan "eight thousand hundred-thousands of eons."
• "Preside" renders a phrase that literally means "exercise authority". The Chinese parallel of this sūtra has the teachers of the ten directions come "to bear witness", which is likely the sense intended here. In "hostile enemies", the Tibetan "kho na" is read as "khon", meaning grudge or hostility.

• "The defining characteristics of the nature of this dhāraṇī" renders a phrase whose key term (dbyings, Sanskrit dhātu) can also mean "sphere" or "element". Brahmā's closing words use a humble idiom that literally says "we will not be able to make the mind forget". It is taken here as a promise never to forget the teaching.
• Several names in the verses are rendered in Tibetan by meaning and cannot be securely identified, so they are given in English: "the Hook-Bearer" (probably Aṅkuśa), "the Mighty One" (possibly Nārāyaṇa, who is paired with Maheśvara in the Chinese parallel), "the Lord of Kapila", "the Treasure Guardian", "Great Eloquence" (perhaps Sarasvatī), "the Glorious One" (perhaps Śrī), and "Earth-Holder". The Tibetan word for Yama literally means "the twins". Transliterated names such as Sasarca, Kulantanta, Pipakala, Pyita, Svārhārā, Sambara, Satana, Paricitra and Phulapa follow the Tibetan spellings. The phrase rendered "lend their power" may instead mean "bear witness", which is how the Chinese parallel puts it.
• The speaker of the verses and of the first-person prose is Avalokiteśvara, per the preceding context. "Sorcery and poisoned darts" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; the parallel Chinese version speaks of a house of gu-poison sorcery, so the sense is a house of poisoners and sorcerers.
• The word rendered "hinder" (gshol ba) is unusual; it is taken in the sense of obstructing or detaining. The parallel Chinese version of this sūtra says the māras and non-Buddhists cannot "detain" the practitioner. "Downwind" renders rdzi phyogs, taking rdzi as "wind."
• "Tathāgata Light of the True Dharma" is translated from the Tibetan; a Sanskrit form (perhaps Saddharmaprabhāsa) is not securely attested, so the English is kept. The rare phrase rendered "deal with no being unjustly" and the expression rendered "act with uprightness" are interpreted in light of the parallel Chinese version of this dhāraṇī.
• The color term in "purple lotus" is uncertain; the Tibetan qualifier may indicate a purplish or dark red hue. The term rendered "wolves" may also denote hyenas or jackals.
• Several materia medica cannot be securely identified. Kabita, giusi and lengsé'u hā are kept as sound-spellings. The Chinese parallel suggests peach resin, apāmārga and a kind of leaf respectively. Kabita might also be kapittha. Wild dog for □□□□□, realgar for □□□□, and white resin for □□□□□□□□□□ are probable but not certain. The Tibetan names Avalokiteśvara as the one who taught the vidyā-mantra, although it was introduced as spoken by the bodhisattva Candraprabha; it is translated as it stands. The text speaks of white and red films and then of blue and white films; both are kept as written. In the snake-bite remedy □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□.
• This text was translated into Tibetan from Chinese, and several substances are Tibetan sound-spellings of Chinese words: □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as lycium (gouqi), □□□□□□□ as bezoar (niuhuang), and □□□ as the Chinese tael. □□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence and is left as "lungtang wood." The reading □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□, "when it comes." The sense of □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is somewhat unclear; it is rendered as "throughout this practice of hearing."
• "The great body" renders □□□□□□□□□, apparently designating the full or extended form of the dhāraṇī; the exact technical sense is uncertain.
• □□□□□□ in the list of limbs is read as □□□□□□, "minor limbs," which the pairing with □□□□□ requires. In "the exceedingly vast mountain of obscurations ... □□□□□□□," the word □□□ ("I, self") fits poorly; it is taken as emphatic ("even") in line with the evident sense. The speaker of the declaration about transgressing "my vidyā-mantra" is not named in this piece; the context implies Avalokiteśvara.
• The disease rendered "fever" (bro nad) is not a common term; the exact ailment is uncertain. The place where the willow twigs are fastened (g.yar kha) is also uncertain; "above the doorway" is a tentative reading. In "especially exalted wisdom," the instrumental kyis appears

to be a slip for kyang ("also"), and is translated that way. Sweet flag (shu dag) renders the medicinal root vacā (Acorus calamus); srang is a unit of weight, given here simply as "one measure."

• "About five finger-widths" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, taking □□□ as a finger-breadth measure; it could also be read as "five colored threads," which seems less fitting here. "One million four thousand" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally (ten hundred-thousands and four thousand).

• "The five pungent foods" renders a phrase usually understood as the five pungent roots, such as garlic and onion, that are avoided in many East Asian–derived ritual texts. The phrase rendered "will be wasted" (literally something like "seeking water") is obscure; it is taken in the sense of fruitless effort. The phrase "Blessed One, ... of the Mother endowed with great miraculous power" could alternatively be read as "the Blessed Mother endowed with great miraculous power"; here the Blessed One is taken as the addressee, as elsewhere in Avalokiteśvara's speech.

• "The god Mahābala" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the god of great might"; the identification is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□□ is taken as Kumāra (Skanda), and □□□□□□□ as Yāma. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "the factors one advances through by view", is obscure.

• The wood called here "khongleng bok" (Tibetan shing khong len 'bog) could not be identified; it is given phonetically. The land name "Gebyin" (ge byin) and the brahmin's name "Cinti" (tsin ti) could not be confidently matched to Sanskrit forms and are given phonetically. The clause about "shutting out all gods and spirits and making no offerings" is somewhat obscure in the Tibetan; the rendering follows the most natural reading, taking "he" who is present before one's eyes to be Avalokiteśvara.

• "Some versions have only eight hand mudrās" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as a misspelling of brgyad pa, "eight". It could instead be a slip for "eighteen", the number of principal arms given just above. The list of principal arms actually describes more than eighteen hands. "Essence Sūtra" translates □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; the work cannot be identified with confidence. □□□□□ is taken as ghee. □□□□□□□□□ is kunduru, a frankincense resin.

• The phrase rendered "if one places it at the doorway" is uncertain; the Tibetan is unclear here, and "doorway" follows the probable sense of the corresponding rite. "Sweet flag" renders the Tibetan for Acorus calamus, a plant used in Indian medicine to sharpen the intellect.

• The "mantra of the Great Body" renders a term that seems to name the text's long root dhāraṇī; its exact Sanskrit is uncertain. The name of the bodhisattva rendered "Water Crystal" is translated literally, since the Sanskrit original could not be identified with confidence; it may stand for something like Jalakānta. "Inexhaustible Treasure" takes the unusual wording of the Tibetan in that sense. "Will not become impaired" for the sense faculties is a tentative reading of an obscure phrase. "Tatapa" is an unidentified substance. The detailed hand positions of the mudrā of great fearlessness are somewhat obscure in the Tibetan.

• The speaker throughout is Avalokiteśvara addressing the Buddha, hence the humble verb forms; in the account of the rākṣasa king the narration shifts from the third person to the first person ("came before me"), as in the Tibetan. "The mantra of the Great Body" renders a phrase that most likely refers to the main dhāraṇī of this text.

• "Great Body mantra" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, apparently reflecting the Chinese "great body mantra" of the source, presumably the main dhāraṇī of the text. The translator Chödrup (Chos grub) is the Tibetan scholar known in Chinese as Facheng, who translated this text from Chinese.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.